

CLAT Express - June 2026: Practice Quizzes

MCQ: +1 for a correct answer, -0.25 for a wrong answer. TITA (type-in-the-answer): +1, no negative marking.

Multiple-choice passages

Islamabad MoU: practice set

In June 2026, the United States and Iran put their signatures to a memorandum known as the Islamabad MoU. The document is designed to halt open hostilities first, with an immediate ceasefire, and then to open a structured period of talks. Those talks are meant to cover three linked areas: nuclear questions, security in the wider region and relief from sanctions. Movement of commercial vessels through a key maritime route would be restored during this negotiation period, reassuring energy-importing countries. The background to the arrangement is a long dispute. An earlier agreement under which Iran accepted curbs on uranium enrichment and tighter inspections, in return for easing of international economic sanctions, was later abandoned by the United States. Iran responded by gradually reducing its compliance with the terms it had accepted. An international nuclear body, whose work includes promoting peaceful nuclear energy and blocking its military use, plays a central role in verifying any nuclear commitments. The accord also envisions a further comprehensive deal, backed by the United Nations Security Council, once negotiations are complete. Many observers remain cautious about whether the timelines can be met.

Q1.

What is the status of the Islamabad MoU compared with a permanent peace treaty?

- (A) It is an interim diplomatic framework rather than a permanent peace treaty
- (B) It is a permanent peace treaty ratified by the UN Security Council
- (C) It is a bilateral trade pact with a fixed tariff schedule
- (D) It is a permanent treaty limited to nuclear inspections only

Q2.

What is the duration of the negotiation process on nuclear issues, regional security and sanctions relief?

- (A) 30 days
- (B) 45 days
- (C) 90 days
- (D) 60 days

Q3.

Assertion (A): The IAEA is headquartered in Vienna and works to promote the peaceful use of nuclear energy.

Reason (R): The IAEA was founded in 1953 when the Atoms for Peace speech was delivered to the UN General Assembly.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Year the IAEA was founded	A. 2005
II. IAEA headquarters	B. Rafael Grossi
III. Year of the IAEA's Nobel Peace Prize	C. Vienna
IV. Current IAEA head	D. 1957

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The IAEA was founded in 1957 and is headquartered in Vienna, Austria.
- II. The JCPOA was concluded between Iran and the P5+1 countries in 2018.
- III. The United States withdrew from the nuclear agreement in 2018.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I and III only

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the Islamabad MoU are correct?

- I. The MoU was signed in June 2026.
- II. Iran is to downblend highly enriched uranium under IAEA supervision.
- III. The MoU was signed in Geneva.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q7.

In which year did the United States withdraw from the 2015 nuclear agreement with Iran?

- (A) 2017
- (B) 2020
- (C) 2019
- (D) 2018

Q8.

Which international organisation, founded in 1957 and headquartered in Vienna, promotes the peaceful use of nuclear energy?

- (A) United Nations Security Council
- (B) P5+1 group
- (C) Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action (JCPOA)
- (D) International Atomic Energy Agency

Visit Outcomes MCQ

Myanmar's President, Min Aung Hlaing, recently completed a five-day official visit to India. It was his first visit since the political transition in Myanmar. The visit came at a time when Myanmar remains central to India's Neighbourhood First Policy, Act East Policy and the wider Indo-Pacific

Vision. During the talks, Myanmar gave an assurance on a sensitive security concern. Its territory, it said, would not be used by anti-India insurgent groups operating near the border. Both sides also agreed to promote wider use of the Rupee-Kyat settlement framework, which is already in operation. The two countries reaffirmed their commitment to complete the Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport Project at the earliest. Efforts were also announced to expedite the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway. In education, India increased the number of ICCR scholarships available to Myanmar students. The outcomes cover security, trade settlement, connectivity and people-to-people ties. The talks also reflected the long history between the two neighbours, whose modern boundary was fixed after the Anglo-Burmese War.

Q1.

Assertion (A): India seeks to enhance its cooperation with Myanmar in line with its Act East Policy.

Reason (R): Myanmar is a member of the Mekong-Ganga Cooperation.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q2.

How many of the following statements about Myanmar's regional memberships are correct?

- Myanmar is a member of BIMSTEC.
- Myanmar is a full member of SAARC.
- Myanmar is part of the Mekong-Ganga Cooperation.
- Bilateral trade with India is conducted under AITIGA.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only three
- (C) All four
- (D) None

Q3.

Consider the following statements about Myanmar's relations with India:

- I. Myanmar is India's only ASEAN neighbour connected through both land and maritime boundaries.
- II. Myanmar is a full member of SAARC.
- III. The India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway passes through Myanmar before reaching Mae Sot in Thailand.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

The Treaty of Yandaboo was signed on behalf of the British by whom?

- (A) Lord Wellesley
- (B) Lord Cornwallis
- (C) Lord Dalhousie
- (D) General Sir Archibald Campbell

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Treaty of Yandaboo	A. 2021
II. Treaty of Friendship	B. 1826
III. Rupee-Kyat settlement framework operational	C. 1951
IV. Military seizure of power in Myanmar	D. 2024

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

What is the total length of the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway?

- (A) 980 km
- (B) 1,200 km
- (C) 1,643 km
- (D) 1,360 km

Q7.

Which Indian states share a boundary with Myanmar?

- (A) Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Manipur and Mizoram
- (B) Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Nagaland
- (C) Sikkim, Assam, Manipur and Mizoram
- (D) Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Nagaland and Tripura

Q8.

Which seaport in Myanmar does the Kaladan project link with Kolkata?

- (A) Yangon Seaport
- (B) Patheingyi Seaport
- (C) Dawei Seaport
- (D) Sittwe Seaport (Rakhine)

Modi's Milestone and the PM's Office

Narendra Modi has become India's longest continuously serving elected Prime Minister. This milestone was reached after he completed a long run of consecutive days in office, counted from the day he took office in 2014. The record he surpassed was an uninterrupted tenure record held by an earlier Prime Minister. The Prime Minister is the head of the Union Government and the leader of the Council of Ministers. He is normally the leader of the majority party in the Lok Sabha, and the President usually invites that leader to form the government. The Prime Minister is also the chief coordinator of government policy and administration, and he chairs the Union Cabinet. The Prime Minister's salary and allowances are decided by Parliament from time to time. Many Prime Ministers of India have held the office for very different lengths of time, and their careers are often compared through such records. Students preparing for examinations should understand both the constitutional rules that govern the office and the historical milestones attached to individual leaders. A clear grasp of appointment, tenure and the Council of Ministers helps in answering questions on the Prime Minister's position in the Union Government. Modi's record is a reminder that the office rests on the confidence of the Lok Sabha, not just on the length of a term.

Q1.

Morarji Desai's birthday was celebrated only once every four years. On which date was he born?

- (A) 15 August
- (B) 28 February
- (C) 1 March
- (D) 29 February

Q2.

Read the statements.

Assertion (A): The Prime Minister holds office during the pleasure of the President.

Reason (R): The President can dismiss the Prime Minister at any time.

Which one of the following is correct?

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Whose uninterrupted tenure record did Modi surpass to become the longest continuously serving elected Prime Minister?

- (A) Jawaharlal Nehru
- (B) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
- (C) Indira Gandhi
- (D) Manmohan Singh

Q4.

Which Article of the Constitution provides for a Council of Ministers headed by the Prime Minister to aid and advise the President?

- (A) Article 72
- (B) Article 73
- (C) Article 76
- (D) Article 74

Q5.

After completing how many consecutive days in office did PM Narendra Modi become India's longest continuously serving elected Prime Minister?

- (A) 4,199 days
- (B) 4,299 days
- (C) 4,499 days
- (D) 4,399 days

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Morarji Desai	A. PM with the shortest tenure
II. Rajiv Gandhi	B. India's oldest Prime Minister
III. V.P. Singh	C. India's youngest Prime Minister
IV. Atal Bihari Vajpayee	D. First PM to leave office after a no-confidence vote

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q7.

How many of the following statements about Narendra Modi are correct?

- I. He is the first Indian Prime Minister born after 15 August 1947.
 - II. He is the first Non-Congress Prime Minister of India.
 - III. He is among the few Indian PMs to secure three consecutive electoral mandates at the Union level.
- (A) Only one
(B) Only two
(C) Only three
(D) None

Passport and Proof of Citizenship

On Passport Seva Divas, observed on June 24, the Ministry of External Affairs set out what an Indian passport does and does not establish. Officials stressed that the document is primarily a travel document. The clarification came at a time when the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls was drawing attention and questions about who counts as a citizen were being raised. Courts have also been asked to examine how much weight a passport carries in legal disputes. The document is taken seriously as evidence of nationality, and the question of citizenship is decided against the criteria that the Constitution and the law provide. The law also lets the government act beyond citizens. A specific statutory provision authorises the Central Government to issue passports to non-citizens in the public interest. Stateless persons and certain refugees have been helped through this route when they needed to travel abroad, which shows that a passport can serve a practical purpose without proving citizenship. Ordinary documents follow the same logic. Many people carry identity cards, voter cards and ration cards in daily life, and each serves a particular purpose. Officials and courts look at what each document establishes and do not treat any one of them as a complete answer to the question of citizenship.

Q1.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Maneka Gandhi vs Union of India (1978)	A. Burden of proof lies on the person claiming citizenship
II. State of Andhra Pradesh vs Abdul Khader (1962)	B. Electoral roll inclusion creates presumption of citizenship
III. Lal Babu Hussein vs Electoral Registration Officer (1995)	C. Passport as supporting evidence
IV. Sarbananda Sonowal vs Union of India (2005)	D. Passport as travel document subject to constitutional protections

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
(B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
(C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
(D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q2.

Which clause of the Assam Accord mandates constitutional, legislative and administrative safeguards for the cultural, social, linguistic identity and heritage of the Assamese people?

- (A) Clause 6
(B) Clause 2
(C) Clause 9
(D) Clause 4

Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- I. India does not permit dual citizenship.
- II. The Citizenship Act, 1955 has been amended six times since 1986.
- III. Persons acquiring citizenship by birth or descent receive a Citizenship Certificate.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

Assertion (A): An Indian passport is conclusive proof of Indian citizenship in legal disputes.

Reason (R): A passport is primarily a travel document and is strong evidence of nationality.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Aadhaar proves identity and residence, not citizenship.
- II. A Voter ID establishes electoral eligibility, not citizenship.
- III. A Ration Card proves citizenship.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q6.

Under which Article of the Constitution was the constitutional validity of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) upheld in *Association for Democratic Reforms vs Election Commission of India* (2026)?

- (A) Article 326
- (B) Article 300A
- (C) Article 368
- (D) Article 324

Q7.

Which section of the Passports Act, 1967 allows the Central Government to issue passports to non-citizens in the public interest?

- (A) Section 20
- (B) Section 15
- (C) Section 10
- (D) Section 25

VB-G RAM G Practice Set

The Union Government has released Draft Rules for the Viksit Bharat — Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act 2025, known as VB-G RAM G. The Act is set to replace the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act from July 2026. It is a Rural Employment and Livelihood Programme that combines wage employment with the creation of durable rural assets. Its objectives include enhancing livelihood security in rural areas, generating productive employment and improving climate resilience.

Employment generation is tied to building rural infrastructure, such as water conservation assets, rural connectivity and climate-resilient community assets. A national infrastructure programme carries this linkage forward. Rural planning is also decentralised and technology-based, and preparing Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans is mandatory.

The Act also allows a seasonal pause in work. States may declare a no-work period, which is meant to address labour shortages in agriculture during peak times. Guaranteed wage employment is to be paid promptly once the work is complete, and the rules fix a clear timeline for this payment.

Funding is changing too. The Draft Rules move away from the open-ended, demand-driven financing model of the earlier scheme. Central allocations will instead follow a normative formula based on devolution criteria, which is meant to bring predictability. Poorer states are to receive a larger share, and any spending beyond the approved allocation must be financed fully by the state.

Q1.

Under the Agricultural Season Pause, how many cumulative days of no-work period may a State declare during peak sowing and harvesting seasons?

- (A) 30 days
- (B) 45 days
- (C) 90 days
- (D) 60 days

Q2.

Under VB-G RAM G, guaranteed wage employment per rural household annually is raised from 100 days to how many days?

- (A) 125 days
- (B) 110 days
- (C) 120 days
- (D) 150 days

Q3.

Within how many days of completion of work must wages be paid under the new Act?

- (A) 7 days
- (B) 30 days
- (C) 10 days
- (D) 15 days

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Agricultural Season Pause	A. Begins from the 2nd year
II. Normative Allocation Formula	B. Fully financed by the concerned State
III. Expenditure beyond approved allocation	C. Cumulative 60-day no-work period
IV. Performance-linked funding	D. Based on 16th Finance Commission devolution criteria

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the VB-G RAM G Act 2025 and its Draft Rules:

- I. The Act is set to replace MGNREGA from July 2026.
- II. The National Level Steering Committee is chaired by the Union Minister for Rural Development.
- III. Performance-linked funding begins from the 2nd year.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements about the Draft Rules are correct?

- I. Central allocations follow a normative allocation formula.
- II. The Centre's share for General States is 90 per cent.
- III. The National Level Steering Committee has 16 members.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q7.

Which portal is to be used for technology integration in decentralised planning under VB-G RAM G?

- (A) UMANG Portal
- (B) DigiLocker Portal
- (C) GeM Portal
- (D) Yuktdhara Portal

Party System and Symbols Practice

India's party system is built on groups of like-minded people who come together to gain political power through constitutional means. These groups organise voluntarily and their aim is to promote the national interest. Not every party enjoys the same status. Some are recognised as national parties and others as state parties, and recognition affects the symbols a party can use. A recognised party may be allotted a symbol for its own exclusive use within its area. Recognition depends on how a party performs at general elections, measured through vote shares and seats won in the Lok Sabha and state legislative assemblies. Registered but unrecognised parties and independent candidates draw their symbols from a different pool. Problems arise when a recognised party splits. Each rival group may claim the party, and the question of who keeps its name and symbol becomes a formal dispute. Such disputes must be settled by a single authority. The framework covers how parties are registered and classified, how symbols are reserved and allotted, and how disputes are handled. Recent public debate about an unusual symbol brought fresh attention to these rules. Understanding this framework helps explain how elections are contested in India and why symbols matter to voters and parties alike.

Q1.

Which term is used for the symbols exclusively allotted to recognised national or state parties?

- (A) Reserved symbols
- (B) Free symbols
- (C) Notified symbols
- (D) Independent symbols

Q2.

Which body is the sole authority empowered to adjudicate disputes arising from splits within recognised political parties?

- (A) Election Commission of India
- (B) Parliament of India
- (C) Supreme Court of India
- (D) Ministry of Law and Justice

Q3.

Which of the following is listed in the booklet as a national party?

- (A) Mizo National Front
- (B) Shiv Sena
- (C) DMK
- (D) Bahujan Samaj Party

Q4.

Assertion (A): A recognised party retains exclusive rights over its symbol.

Reason (R): Free symbols are available to registered unrecognised parties and independent candidates.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Sadiq Ali and Another v. ECI (1972)	A. Triggered when neither faction shows a clear majority
II. Kanhaiyalal Omar v. R.K. Trivedi (1986)	B. Allotted by ECI from a notified list
III. Symbol freeze	C. Legislative majority alone is not the sole criterion
IV. Free symbols	D. Symbols Order is a valid exercise of ECI's powers

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the statements:

- I. Recognised national or state parties may be allotted a symbol for exclusive use in their jurisdiction.
- II. Free symbols are allotted by the ECI from a notified list.
- III. The Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968 was issued by the Supreme Court of India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the statements:

- I. India follows a multi-party system.
- II. The one-party system is the one followed in the USA.
- III. The ECI recognised both Congress (O) and Congress (R) after the split in the Indian National Congress.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q8.

Under what condition may the ECI freeze a party's original symbol?

- (A) When both factions agree to freeze it
- (B) When the Supreme Court orders a freeze
- (C) When neither faction demonstrates a clear majority
- (D) When the party fails to contest elections for two consecutive terms

Telegram ban: misuse and blocking context

Telegram, a messaging platform, has come under scrutiny in India after the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) temporarily blocked it under Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, 2000. The action followed reports that criminal groups had used Telegram's message-editing feature to target and defraud candidates appearing in the NEET-UG 2026 Re-Examination. Fraudsters reportedly inserted fake exam papers into old messages after an exam had ended, creating a false appearance of a pre-exam leak and spreading misinformation. The platform's privacy features add to the concern. Hidden phone numbers and end-to-end encryption in secret chats make it nearly impossible for investigators to trace malicious actors. The platform also permits the sharing of massive files, which makes it easy to distribute high-resolution PDFs of leaked documents. Telegram hosts active marketplaces for renting bank accounts used in money laundering, extortion, and illegal gambling. Criminals use automated bots to distribute illegal content and coordinate large-scale activities with minimal manual effort. Government data shows a sharp increase in official cybercrime complaints linked to activities organised within Telegram groups. Section 69A empowers the Central Government, or an officer it specially authorises, to direct any government agency or intermediary to block public access to online information. The episode shows how platform features can be misused for organised fraud against candidates.

Q1.

Under the DPDP Act 2023, what is the term for the individual whose data is processed?

- (a) Data Fiduciary
 - (b) Data Processor
 - (c) Data Principal
 - (d) Data Custodian
- (A) Data Fiduciary
 - (B) Data Processor
 - (C) Data Principal
 - (D) Data Custodian

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Section 69A	A. Direct takedown or blocking orders by certain ministries
II. Section 79(3)(b)	B. Up to 250 crore
III. Tanul Thakur case	C. Introduced in 2008
IV. DPDP Act 2023 maximum penalty	D. Disclosure of original blocking orders

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q3.

In Tanul Thakur vs Union of India (2022), the Delhi High Court challenged the blanket confidentiality of which Rule?

- (a) Rule 4
 - (b) Rule 7
 - (c) Rule 12
 - (d) Rule 16
- (A) Rule 4
 - (B) Rule 7
 - (C) Rule 12
 - (D) Rule 16

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Designated Committee evaluates necessity and legality of a proposed blocking action before implementation.
- II. The IT (Blocking Rules), 2009 provide for an Inter-Ministerial Review Mechanism for blocking requests.
- III. In Shreya Singhal vs Union of India (2015), the Supreme Court struck down Section 69A as vague.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) I and II only
 - (b) II and III only
 - (c) I and III only
 - (d) I, II and III
- (A) I and II only
 - (B) II and III only
 - (C) I and III only
 - (D) I, II and III

Q5.

In which year was Section 69A of the IT Act introduced?

- (a) 2000
 - (b) 2005
 - (c) 2008
 - (d) 2012
- (A) 2000
 - (B) 2005
 - (C) 2008
 - (D) 2012

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Interim Blocking Directions may be issued in urgent situations before a Full Review.
- II. Safe harbour under Section 79 is granted even to intermediaries that do not act upon notified violations.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) II only
 - (b) I only
 - (c) Both I and II
 - (d) Neither I nor II
- (A) II only
 - (B) I only
 - (C) Both I and II
 - (D) Neither I nor II

Revision and PPI: MCQ Practice

Price indices are widely used to track inflation, and the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) is a key measure among them. The Government of India has now approved a revision of the WPI base year, moving the reference point of the index to a more recent period. A base year is the reference period against which later price movements are measured, so changing it allows the index to reflect the structure of the modern economy more accurately. Economic activity has changed considerably since the earlier base year was fixed. The revision therefore aims to capture these shifts in the composition of goods, in the way they are classified and in the way their relative importance is measured. Accurate measurement matters because the WPI sits early in the supply chain, and its movements often signal pressures that may later reach consumers. Alongside the revised WPI, the Government has decided to introduce new Producer Price Indices. These indices are meant to give a wider picture of the prices that producers receive and pay, and of the costs they face in production. Together, the revised series is expected to provide a more complete view of inflation at the producer level, helping policymakers, businesses and analysts read cost and price dynamics with greater confidence.

Q1.

The 2011-12 WPI series covered 697 items. By how many items did the item count rise in the revised series with 2022-23 as base year?

- (A) 160
- (B) 220
- (C) 300
- (D) 260

Q2.

Which index measures changes in prices received by producers for the goods and services they sell?

- (A) Output Producer Price Index
- (B) Input Producer Price Index
- (C) Wholesale Price Index
- (D) Service Producer Price Index

Q3.

In the revised WPI series, Crude Petroleum and Natural Gas were moved between categories. Which move describes this change?

- (A) From Manufactured Products to Primary Articles
- (B) From Fuel and Power to Manufactured Products
- (C) From Primary Articles to Manufactured Products
- (D) From Primary Articles to Fuel and Power

Q4.

Assertion (A): The revised WPI series uses weights based on Gross Value of Output rather than Net Traded Value.

Reason (R): The earlier WPI method calculated weights as Gross Value of Output plus imports minus exports.

Choose the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Input Producer Price Index	A. Missing prices replaced by the last available price
II. Output Producer Price Index	B. Prices received by service providers for services rendered
III. Service Producer Price Index	C. Prices paid by producers for inputs used in production
IV. Carry-Forward Method	D. Prices received by producers for goods and services they sell

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

I. The revised WPI series has 957 items, up from 697 in the 2011-12 series.

II. Crude Petroleum and Natural Gas are classified under Primary Articles in the revised series.

III. The revised series uses Targeted Mean Imputation to treat missing data.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

- I. Solar Power is one of the components newly added in the revised WPI series.
- II. The new missing-data approach is the Carry-Forward Method.
- III. The Output PPI measures prices before taxes, trade margins and transportation costs.
- IV. Pension Fund Management is among the services covered by the Service PPI.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Q8.

Which method, previously used for missing prices, was replaced in the revised WPI series by Targeted Mean Imputation?

- (A) Carry-Forward Method
- (B) Linear interpolation
- (C) Moving average method
- (D) Seasonal adjustment

G7 Evolution Check

The Group of Seven, commonly called the G7, did not begin as a fixed club of advanced economies. It was set up as a response to a period of unsettled global economics and a major energy shock, when leading industrialised nations felt the need to consult closely with one another. The original group was a small circle of Western and Asian economies, and it later added a new member that turned the forum into a larger body for some years. Afterwards, the membership changed again when one participant's involvement was halted. The forum then returned to its earlier arrangement, which remains in place today. Each phase reshaped the membership, but the group's consultative purpose stayed the same over the decades. Throughout these changes, the grouping has kept its informal character, meeting to discuss pressing economic, political and strategic questions rather than operating as a formal treaty organisation. The history of the G7 therefore shows how a forum can grow, shrink and reorganise in response to global events while keeping its core purpose of consultation. The forum brings together some of the world's most advanced industrialised economies. The chronology also helps explain the forum's present-day role as a platform for consultation among major economies.

Q1.

In which year was the G7 established in response to global economic turbulence and an oil crisis?

- (A) 1973
- (B) 1976
- (C) 1980
- (D) 1975

Q2.

Which country joined the grouping in 1976, creating the G7?

- (A) Canada
- (B) Russia
- (C) Japan
- (D) Mexico

Q3.

Russia's participation in the grouping was suspended in 2014 for which reason?

- (A) Violation of trade agreements
- (B) Economic sanctions over nuclear testing
- (C) Annexation of Crimea
- (D) Interference in elections

Q4.

Given the assertion and reason below, choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): Russia's participation in the G7 was suspended in 2014.

Reason (R): Russia's participation was suspended following the annexation of Crimea.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Establishment of the grouping	A. 2014
II. Canada joins the grouping	B. 1998
III. Russia joins the grouping	C. 1976
IV. Russia's participation suspended	D. 1975

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the G7:

- I. The grouping was established in 1975 in response to global economic turbulence and an oil crisis.
- II. The European Union is counted as a formal member of the G7.
- III. Leadership of the G7 rotates annually among member states.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the G7 are correct?

- I. Canada was among the founding members of the grouping in 1975.
 - II. Russia's joining in 1998 led to the formation of the G8.
 - III. The G7 format was restored after Russia's participation was suspended in 2014.
 - IV. The 52nd G7 Summit was held in Paris, France.
- (A) Only two
 - (B) Only one
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None of the above

Q8.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Italy was among the founding members of the grouping.
- II. Canada was among the founding members of the grouping.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) Neither I nor II
- (B) II only
- (C) I only
- (D) Both I and II

Quad at a glance: MCQ set

The Quad is a grouping of India, the United States, Japan and Australia that has grown from a set of humanitarian contacts into a diplomatic grouping. Its roots lie in cooperation that followed a devastating disaster in the Indian Ocean region. A Japanese leader later gave the idea a sharper political shape, and the grouping was revitalised in response to growing unease about the expanding military and economic presence of a large regional power in the Indo-Pacific.

Today the Quad works as an informal strategic partnership rather than a formal alliance. Its stated aim is a region that is free, open, inclusive, secure and prosperous, anchored in the rule of law, freedom of navigation, territorial integrity and the peaceful resolution of disputes. These principles are applied in practice through specific initiatives, each with its own focus areas and objectives.

The eleventh foreign ministers' meeting of the group turned these ideas into concrete outcomes across several areas. Maritime cooperation is one strand, with shared surveillance tools and data arrangements focused initially on the Indian Ocean. Other outcomes cover critical minerals, energy, undersea connectivity, digital identity systems and agriculture. Many of these efforts aim to reduce dependence on a few suppliers and to build resilient supply chains and infrastructure across the region.

Q1.

Assertion (A): The Quad is an informal strategic partnership.

Reason (R): Quad stands for Quadrilateral Security Dialogue.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q2.

How many of the following statements about the Quad are correct?

- I. The Quad stands for Quadrilateral Security Dialogue.
- II. South Korea is a full member of the Quad.
- III. India will host the next edition of the Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission.
- IV. The Quad Counterterrorism Tabletop Exercise is to be hosted by Japan in 2026.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q3.

Which threats are among the focus areas of the Quad Counterterrorism Tabletop Exercise?

- (A) Unmanned Aerial Vehicle threats
- (B) Cyber espionage
- (C) Maritime piracy
- (D) Oil spills

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Malabar Exercise	A. Agricultural productivity and food security
II. AI-ENGAGE Initiative	B. Collaboration with Fiji
III. Quad Counterterrorism Tabletop Exercise	C. Annual multilateral naval exercise of Quad members
IV. Pacific Island Infrastructure Outreach	D. Hosted by Australia in 2026

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q5.

By which year is the Pacific Island Infrastructure Outreach targeted for completion?

- (A) 2026
- (B) 2028
- (C) 2030
- (D) 2024

Q6.

Where was the 11th Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting held?

- (A) Tokyo
- (B) Washington D.C.
- (C) New Delhi
- (D) Canberra

Q7.

Consider the following statements about Quad initiatives:

- I. The Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission was launched under the Wilmington Declaration.
- II. The Indo-Pacific Energy Security Initiative includes a Joint Regional Energy Roadmap with a commitment of over USD 25 million.
- III. The Quad Counterterrorism Tabletop Exercise in 2026 is to be hosted by India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q8.

Who championed the Quad concept in 2007?

- (A) Joe Biden
- (B) Scott Morrison
- (C) Narendra Modi
- (D) Shinzo Abe

E85 Basics Check

India is considering a policy framework to make the adoption of E85 fuel affordable. Ethanol is a highly purified alcohol that can be blended with petrol and used as a transport fuel. Ethanol blending means mixing ethanol with petrol to create fuel that can run internal combustion engines. The idea is to lower the country's reliance on imported crude oil while giving farmers a steady market for their produce. Ethanol is derived from plant-based sources, and the wider family of biofuels also includes fuels made from animal waste. The Ethanol Blending Programme began as a pilot and was later widened under a national policy on biofuels. The programme set a target of blending twenty per cent ethanol, written as E20. Officials also stress environmental gains, since ethanol replaces fossil fuels and lowers greenhouse gas emissions. E85 is a fuel blend that carries much more ethanol than ordinary petrol, and the policy discussion is about making it affordable. Read together, these points show how energy security, farm incomes and cleaner air are linked in the rollout of ethanol fuels. The discussion also considers rural livelihoods, since farmers supply the raw material that makes the fuel possible. Supporters argue that ethanol stocks can help manage prices when crude oil costs rise sharply. Critics, however, raise questions about how crops diverted to fuel affect food supply and whether ordinary vehicle owners will see lower running costs. Any framework that aims for affordable adoption must balance these competing concerns while keeping the programme's environmental goals in view.

Q1.

Which ministry is the nodal ministry for the Ethanol Blending Programme?

- (A) Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas
- (B) Ministry of New and Renewable Energy
- (C) Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare
- (D) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Q2.

What is the composition of E85 fuel?

- (A) 85% petrol and 15% ethanol
- (B) 80% ethanol and 20% petrol
- (C) 85% ethanol and 15% petrol
- (D) 75% ethanol and 25% petrol

Q3.

In which year was the E20 blending target achieved?

- (A) 2025
- (B) 2024
- (C) 2027
- (D) 2029

Q4.

What is the approximate purity of the ethanol used for blending?

- (A) About 75%
- (B) About 90%
- (C) About 99.9%
- (D) About 50%

Q5.

Assertion (A): E85 fuel can be used in standard petrol-engine vehicles without any modification.

Reason (R): E85 can be used only in Flex-Fuel Vehicles designed to operate on varying ethanol-petrol blends.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Ethanol Blending Programme pilot launch	A. 2023
II. Target year for E20 blending	B. 2018
III. Global Biofuels Alliance launch	C. 2030
IV. National Policy on Biofuels	D. 2003

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Major feedstocks for ethanol include sugarcane, maize and wheat.
- II. E85 fuel can be used in all petrol-engine vehicles without any change.
- III. Flex-fuel vehicles are designed to operate on different ethanol-petrol blends.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q8.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Ethanol and biodiesel are the most common biofuels.
- II. GOBAR-DHAN focuses on converting cattle dung and solid waste into compost, biogas and bio-CNG.
- III. The Repurpose Used Cooking Oil initiative was launched by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Forests, Wetlands and Wildlife Drives

India's efforts to protect its green cover combine large national missions with focused local drives. The National Mission for Green India concentrates on expanding forest and tree cover while also improving the quality of the cover that already exists. Funds for compensatory afforestation are managed by a dedicated authority, which supports regeneration on degraded land. India also protects its wetlands, and several of these are recognised as Ramsar Sites. Two major programmes were started to protect large wild animals, one focused on tigers and another on elephants. Along the coastline, mangroves are being promoted through a national initiative that seeks to support both habitats and local livelihoods. The Aravalli Green Wall is a planned green belt along a mountain range. Public participation is also encouraged, and campaigns invite ordinary people to plant trees as part of the effort. India further publishes a periodic national report on the condition of its forests. Taken together, these measures show how planning, public funds, wildlife protection and citizen action work side by side to protect the natural environment.

Q1.

In which year was Project Tiger launched by India?

- (A) 1972
- (B) 1992
- (C) 1973
- (D) 2014

Q2.

As of now, how many Ramsar Sites has India expanded its count to?

- (A) 75
- (B) 82
- (C) 95
- (D) 100

Q3.

In which Union Budget was the MISHTI mangrove initiative announced?

- (A) 2014-15
- (B) 2016-17
- (C) 2023-24
- (D) 2024-25

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam	A. Launched in 1992
II. MISHTI	B. Plant trees in memory of one's mother
III. CAMPA Funds	C. Promote and conserve mangroves
IV. Project Elephant	D. Afforestation on waste, vacant and barren lands

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The National Mission for Green India is one of the missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change.
- II. The Aravalli Green Wall is planned as a green belt 5 km wide.
- III. Project Elephant was launched before Project Tiger.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The Green India Mission targets increasing forest and tree cover on 5 million hectares.
- II. The 16th COP to the UNCCD was held in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia, in 2024.
- III. India ranks first globally in net forest area gain over the past 15 years.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam campaign links tree planting with an emotional appeal.
- II. The Aravalli Green Wall is 1,000 km long and runs from Jaisalmer to Delhi.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II only
- (C) Both I and II
- (D) Neither I nor II

Defence and Nuclear Developments

Defence and nuclear developments featured prominently this month. The annual SIPRI Yearbook 2026, published by the Stockholm International Peace Research Institute, highlights rising global militarisation, nuclear modernisation and India's evolving nuclear posture. It reports that India's defence expenditure rose to USD 92.1 billion in 2025, placing India among the world's largest military spenders.

India's nuclear decision-making rests on its Nuclear Command Authority, which has two bodies. The Political Council is the sole body authorised to release nuclear weapons, while the Executive Council provides inputs to it and executes its directives.

On air defence, India has received the fourth squadron of the S-400 Triumf system from Russia, which is designated Sudarshan in Indian service. India has also signed a deal to supply BrahMos supersonic cruise missiles to Vietnam, as announced during the Shangri-La Dialogue. BrahMos was used in combat for the first time during Operation Sindoor.

Globally, military spending reached USD 2.9 trillion in 2025, marking the 11th consecutive year of growth. The world retained 12,187 nuclear warheads, and nuclear-armed states continue to rely on nuclear deterrence as a strategic tool. The Yearbook also notes that Ukraine recorded the highest military burden in the world, with its military spending equivalent to 40% of its GDP.

Q1.

Which authority chairs the Executive Council of India's Nuclear Command Authority?

- (A) Prime Minister
- (B) President of India
- (C) Defence Minister
- (D) National Security Advisor

Q2.

Assertion (A): India signed a USD 5.43 billion agreement with Russia in 2018 for five S-400 regimental systems.

Reason (R): The S-400 system is designed and manufactured by Almaz-Antey.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Iron Dome	A. China
II. S-500 Prometey	B. USA
III. HQ-9	C. Russia
IV. THAAD	D. Israel

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the BrahMos missile:

- I. It is a supersonic cruise missile operating at Mach 2.8.
- II. It is capable of carrying a nuclear warhead.
- III. It is jointly developed by India's DRDO and Russia's NPOM.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about India's nuclear milestones are correct?

- I. 1974: first nuclear test at Pokhran, known as Smiling Buddha.
- II. 1998: Operation Shakti established India as a nuclear weapons state.
- III. 2008: India secured an NSG waiver.
- IV. 1998: India formally adopted its nuclear doctrine.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q6.

Approximately what share of all nuclear warheads in the world is held collectively by the USA and Russia?

- (A) About 40%
- (B) About 50%
- (C) About 65%
- (D) About 86%

Q7.

Which country was the first state ever to withdraw from the Convention on Cluster Munitions, in 2025?

- (A) Lithuania
- (B) Estonia
- (C) Poland
- (D) Latvia

Q8.

At which centre is the BrahMos Integration and Testing Facility located?

- (A) Lucknow
- (B) Ooty
- (C) Pune
- (D) Hyderabad

Iran-U.S. Nuclear Diplomacy: Background

Nuclear diplomacy between Iran and the United States has moved through several phases. For a long period, Iran faced extensive sanctions, and its nuclear programme was the central point of dispute between the two countries. A later arrangement was reached with a group of major world powers, and it set specific terms for Iran's nuclear activities. In 2018, the United States withdrew from the nuclear agreement, and Iran then gradually scaled back its compliance with several of the commitments it had accepted. The present phase of diplomacy began in June 2026, when the United States and Iran signed the Islamabad Memorandum of Understanding. The booklet describes this document as an interim diplomatic framework rather than a permanent peace treaty. The memorandum outlines a fourteen-point roadmap. It covers de-escalation of hostilities, restoration of commercial navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, discussions on sanctions relief and confidence-building measures between both countries. A proposal also envisages a comprehensive agreement backed by the UN Security Council once negotiations conclude. Phased sanctions relief and easing of restrictions on Iranian oil exports are part of the arrangement under discussion. The document also provides for oversight of implementation and for restricted assets to be unlocked. Iran has reaffirmed its nuclear pledge, and talks are to begin after key steps are taken.

Q1.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Iran agreed to restrict uranium enrichment activities under the JCPOA.
- II. The JCPOA was concluded in 2013.
- III. Iran agreed to reduce its nuclear stockpiles under the JCPOA.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q2.

Assertion (A): Iran agreed to permit enhanced international inspections under the JCPOA.

Reason (R): Iran gradually scaled back compliance with several JCPOA commitments.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Iran's scaled-back compliance with JCPOA commitments related mainly to which two areas?

- (A) Food security and water
- (B) Missile testing and regional trade
- (C) Oil exports and banking
- (D) Uranium enrichment and nuclear monitoring

Q4.

In which year was the Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action concluded?

- (A) 2013
- (B) 2019
- (C) 2015
- (D) 2017

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Iran agreed to permit enhanced international inspections under the JCPOA.
- II. The JCPOA was concluded between Iran and the P5 countries only.
- III. Iran agreed to restrict uranium enrichment activities under the JCPOA.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

The JCPOA was concluded between Iran and which group of countries?

- (A) G7 nations
- (B) P5 countries only
- (C) NATO members
- (D) P5+1 countries

Q7.

Under the JCPOA, Iran agreed to reduce what?

- (A) Its nuclear stockpiles
- (B) Its oil exports
- (C) Its military budget
- (D) Its border troops

The IAEA: Context and Purpose

The International Atomic Energy Agency is a central body in discussions about nuclear energy and its uses. It was founded in 1957 and is headquartered in Vienna, Austria. One of its stated aims is to promote the peaceful use of nuclear energy, and this aim sits at the core of much of its work. The agency has become prominent in the current dispute between Iran and the United States. The Islamabad Memorandum of Understanding, signed in June 2026, provides for downblending of highly enriched uranium under IAEA supervision. The booklet describes that memorandum as an interim diplomatic framework rather than a permanent peace treaty. The memorandum also covers restoration of commercial navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, discussions on sanctions relief, and confidence-building measures between both countries. Its fourteen points are meant to lead toward a comprehensive agreement, which the booklet says would be backed by the UN Security Council. Negotiations on nuclear issues, regional security and sanctions relief follow the initial steps. The memorandum also provides for restricted assets to be unlocked, for oversight of implementation, and for Iran to refrain from nuclear weapon development. The agency's supervision of nuclear material is part of the arrangement under discussion. Iran has also

reaffirmed its nuclear pledge.

Q1.

The 'Atoms for Peace' speech of which US president is the origin the IAEA is said to have grown out of?

- (A) Harry S. Truman
- (B) Franklin D. Roosevelt
- (C) Dwight D. Eisenhower
- (D) John F. Kennedy

Q2.

To which UN body was the 'Atoms for Peace' speech delivered?

- (A) UN General Assembly
- (B) UN Security Council
- (C) UNESCO
- (D) UN Human Rights Council

Q3.

The IAEA's objective includes inhibiting the use of nuclear energy for what purpose?

- (A) Agricultural purposes
- (B) Medical purposes
- (C) Space exploration
- (D) Military purposes

Q4.

Assertion (A): The IAEA is an intergovernmental organization.

Reason (R): The IAEA was born out of a speech given in 1953.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Current head of the IAEA	A. 2005
II. Year of the Nobel Peace Prize award	B. Intergovernmental organization
III. Type of the IAEA	C. 1953
IV. Year of the 'Atoms for Peace' speech	D. Rafael Grossi

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The IAEA was born out of a speech given to the UN General Assembly in 1953.
- II. The IAEA is a non-governmental organisation.
- III. Rafael Grossi is the head of the IAEA.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The IAEA was founded in 1953.
- II. The IAEA is an intergovernmental organization.
- III. The IAEA was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize in 2005.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Treaty of Yandaboo and Its Legacy

Myanmar's President, Min Aung Hlaing, undertook a five-day official visit to India, his first since the 2021 political transition in Myanmar. Myanmar holds a central place in India's Neighbourhood First Policy, its Act East Policy and its wider Indo-Pacific vision. It is the only ASEAN nation that shares a land border with India, and the two countries are connected by both land and sea. The booklet describes Myanmar as a geographic bridge linking India with Southeast Asia. To understand the relationship, it helps to look at the past. For a long period, a large part of the Indian territory lying in the east was under the control of the Myanmar side. This situation changed with a treaty known as the Treaty of Yandaboo. The treaty was signed by representatives of the British and of the Myanmar side. Its signing also brought an end to a war fought between the two powers. Myanmar's position also places it close to India's island territories, which makes maritime cooperation important for regional stability. The visit's outcomes included cooperation on counter-insurgency, as Myanmar assured India that its territory would not be used by anti-India insurgent groups operating near the frontier. Both countries also discussed connectivity in the wider relationship.

Q1.

Which Indian region was under the control of the Myanmar side for a long period until the treaty?

- (A) Western Ghats
- (B) Deccan Plateau
- (C) North-East Region
- (D) Thar Desert

Q2.

In which year was the Treaty of Yandaboo signed?

- (A) 1824
- (B) 1842
- (C) 1851
- (D) 1826

Q3.

What did the Treaty of Yandaboo establish?

- (A) The current India-Myanmar boundary
- (B) A trade agreement between ASEAN and India
- (C) The Trilateral Highway
- (D) The Kaladan project

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the Treaty of Yandaboo:

- I. Much of India's North-East Region was under Burmese occupation until the treaty.
- II. The treaty was signed in 1851.
- III. The treaty established the current India-Myanmar boundary.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the Anglo-Burmese War are correct?

- I. The Treaty of Yandaboo ended the war.
- II. The war is dated 1824-1826.
- III. The war was fought between the British and the Burmese side in 1851.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

Which war did the Treaty of Yandaboo end?

- (A) Anglo-Burmese War of 1824-1826
- (B) Anglo-Afghan War of 1839-1842
- (C) Anglo-Sikh War of 1845-1846
- (D) Anglo-Maratha War of 1817-1818

Connectivity Projects and the Visit

Connectivity was one of the themes of the visit by Myanmar's President to India. The booklet lists two connectivity projects among the outcomes of the visit. The first is the Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport Project, which combines different modes of transport to link India with Myanmar. The second is the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway, a land route that connects India with Thailand. The highway is a major road project, and it was discussed alongside the transit project during the visit. The booklet describes the transit project as a route that uses more than one mode of transport. The booklet describes Myanmar as central to India's Neighbourhood First Policy and Act East Policy. It also describes Myanmar as a link between India and Southeast Asia, and it notes that Myanmar's geographic proximity to India's island territories makes maritime cooperation important. The booklet presents both projects as part of the broader relationship between the two countries. The booklet's list of outcomes also includes educational cooperation, under which India increased the number of ICCR scholarships available to Myanmar students. The booklet also records a Rupee-Kyat settlement framework that both sides agreed to promote. The visit was the first official visit by Myanmar's President to India since the 2021 political transition.

Q1.

The name of the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway refers to how many countries?

- (A) Two
- (B) Four
- (C) Five
- (D) Three

Q2.

The Trilateral Highway passes through which country before reaching Mae Sot in Thailand?

- (A) Bangladesh
- (B) Laos
- (C) Myanmar
- (D) Cambodia

Q3.

Consider the following statements about the connectivity projects:

- I. Both countries reaffirmed commitment to complete the Kaladan project at the earliest.
- II. The Trilateral Highway passes through Thailand before reaching Myanmar.
- III. Efforts were announced to expedite the Trilateral Highway's implementation.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

How many of the following statements about the connectivity projects are correct?

- I. The Kaladan project is a multi-modal transit transport project.
- II. The Trilateral Highway starts in Thailand.
- III. Efforts to expedite the Trilateral Highway's implementation were announced.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

Assertion (A): India and Myanmar agreed to complete the Kaladan project at the earliest.

Reason (R): Both connectivity projects were featured among the outcomes of the visit.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) A is false but R is true
- (D) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

Q6.

What did both countries reaffirm about the Kaladan project?

- (A) Commitment to complete it at the earliest
- (B) Shifting its route to Thailand
- (C) Handing it over to ASEAN
- (D) Suspending it until 2030

Q7.

What did the booklet say was announced for the Trilateral Highway during the visit?

- (A) Its route would be changed to avoid Myanmar
- (B) Its length would be revised
- (C) Its construction would be suspended
- (D) Efforts to expedite its implementation

Myanmar's Takeover and Its Aftermath

Myanmar has experienced a sharp change of control in recent years. The army took over the government after alleging huge irregularities in a parliamentary election held in November. Troops seized a city hall just ahead of the announcement, and the army then declared a state of emergency. Elected civilian leaders were taken into custody before the new parliament could convene. Communication services were restricted, and banks were closed across the country. A former general who was serving as vice president was set to become the acting head of state. The party that had secured two landslide victories in democratic elections was among those affected by these events. The booklet presents these events as what we know so far, and it lists them in a short timeline that starts with the allegations about the polls. The army's announcement was followed by a period of restricted communications and closed banks, as the timeline records. Myanmar's current President has since made his first official visit to India after this change. The booklet describes that visit as a five-day official trip, and it notes that it was his first visit to India since the transition.

Q1.

Who was to become acting president after the takeover?

- (A) Myint Swe
- (B) Win Myint
- (C) Min Aung Hlaing
- (D) Htin Kyaw

Q2.

On which date did the military seize power in Myanmar?

- (A) February 1, 2021
- (B) November 1, 2020
- (C) January 1, 2021
- (D) February 1, 2020

Q3.

For how long did the army declare the state of emergency?

- (A) Six months
- (B) One year
- (C) Two years
- (D) Three years

Q4.

Assertion (A): The military took power in Myanmar in 2015.

Reason (R): The NLD won landslide victories in 2015 and 2020.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Myint Swe	A. Declared a state of emergency after the takeover
II. Aung San Suu Kyi	B. Won landslide victories in 2015 and 2020
III. National League for Democracy	C. Former general and vice president
IV. The army	D. Taken into custody hours before parliament convened

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the takeover:

- I. The army declared a state of emergency after the takeover.
- II. Banks were kept open nationwide during the takeover.
- III. Myint Swe was a former general and the vice president.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Forming the Government and the Council of Ministers

Appointing a Prime Minister is one of the first steps in forming a government in India. The Constitution says the President makes the appointment, but the President does not have complete freedom in the selection. In ordinary circumstances, the President invites the leader of the party that holds a majority in the Lok Sabha. If no single party has a clear majority, the President has to decide whom to invite by judging who is likely to win the confidence of the House. The Prime Minister holds office during the pleasure of the President. The Prime Minister leads a team of ministers known as the Council of Ministers. This team includes Cabinet Ministers, who are senior members placed below the Prime Minister, along with Ministers of State and Deputy Ministers. Each group has its own role in running government departments. Ministers may sit in Parliament or be appointed from outside it for a limited period. Ministers of State are one of the categories within this team, and the booklet describes their roles in detail. Taken together, these arrangements explain how the executive is formed, how the Prime Minister's position is structured, and how ministers take part in the work of Parliament.

Q1.

In the booklet's list of the Prime Minister's key functions, the PM is described as Chairperson of which body?

- (A) Union Cabinet
- (B) Election Commission
- (C) Planning Commission
- (D) National Security Council

Q2.

Assertion (A): Cabinet Ministers are senior members of the Council of Ministers placed below the Prime Minister.

Reason (R): Ministers of State are senior to Cabinet Ministers in the Council of Ministers.

Which one of the following is correct?

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Which category of ministers is described as operating independently, without oversight from Cabinet Ministers or Council of Ministers members?

- (A) Deputy Ministers
- (B) Ministers of State (Independent Charge) [MoS (IC)]
- (C) Cabinet Ministers
- (D) Ministers of State assisting Cabinet Ministers

Q4.

According to the booklet, which key ministries are overseen by Cabinet Ministers?

- (A) Railways, Health and Education
- (B) Agriculture, Labour and Tourism
- (C) Law, Petroleum and Telecom
- (D) Home Affairs, Finance and Defence

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Prime Minister is the Head of the Union Government and Leader of the Council of Ministers.
- II. The President can dismiss the Prime Minister at any time.
- III. A member of the Rajya Sabha can never be made Prime Minister.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Deputy Ministers assist Cabinet Ministers or Ministers of State with administrative, political and parliamentary duties.
- II. The Prime Minister's term is fixed at five years by the Constitution.
- III. The Prime Minister is the Head of the Executive.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

When no single party has a clear majority, the President invites a person who can command support of how many parties?

- (A) One party alone, the largest in the Lok Sabha
- (B) Two or more parties that together form a Lok Sabha majority
- (C) A coalition of Rajya Sabha members only
- (D) The party with the most seats in the previous government

Modi's Records and Prime Ministerial Firsts

Narendra Modi became India's longest continuously serving elected Prime Minister after completing 4,399 consecutive days in office. He had taken office on 26 May 2014, and this period surpassed the uninterrupted record held by Jawaharlal Nehru. The booklet explains that Nehru's overall tenure as Prime Minister lasted about 6,131 days, but that this total includes time when he served as head of an interim government before the first general elections. The Lok Sabha has 543 seats, and the party or alliance that commands a majority is normally called upon to form the government. Several Prime Ministers of India are noted for records that the booklet describes in short facts. These facts include the age at which a Prime Minister took office, the years in which the Prime Minister served, and the house of Parliament from which a Prime Minister came. Modi's record is described in the context of the country's general elections, and the booklet measures it in days rather than years. The booklet also notes that Nehru was the first Prime Minister of India and the first to die in office. Taken together, these facts give a useful picture of how the record of India's Prime Ministers can be compared.

Q1.

Which PM is described as the first Indian Prime Minister born after 15 August 1947?

- (A) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
- (B) Manmohan Singh
- (C) Narendra Modi
- (D) Rajiv Gandhi

Q2.

How many of the 543 Lok Sabha seats did the BJP-led NDA win in 2014?

- (A) 272
- (B) 336
- (C) 320
- (D) 350

Q3.

Which PM is described as India's 2nd PM of South Indian origin, from Karnataka?

- (A) P.V. Narasimha Rao
- (B) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
- (C) I.K. Gujral
- (D) H.D. Deve Gowda

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Morarji Desai	A. PM with the shortest tenure (16 days)
II. Rajiv Gandhi	B. First Non-Congress PM
III. V.P. Singh	C. Youngest PM at 40 years
IV. Atal Bihari Vajpayee	D. First PM to leave office after a no-confidence vote

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Modi is among the few Indian PMs to secure 3 consecutive electoral mandates at the Union level.
- II. Morarji Desai was India's youngest PM.
- III. Atal Bihari Vajpayee's tenure was the longest of any PM.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. Rajiv Gandhi was India's youngest PM, at 40 years.
- II. Gulzarilal Nanda was the only man to have twice served as Acting Prime Minister of India.
- III. Morarji Desai was born in the 20th century.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

VB-G RAM G: Objectives and Planning

The Union Government has released Draft Rules under the VB-G RAM G Act. VB-G RAM G is described as a Rural Employment and Livelihood Programme, and the Draft Rules explain how it will operate in practice, including how central funds are allocated and how costs are shared between the Centre and the States.

The Draft Rules move away from an open-ended, demand-driven financing model. Under the new approach, central allocations are determined through a Normative Allocation Formula based on devolution criteria recommended by a Finance Commission. The stated aim is predictability in resource allocation and alignment with the principles of fiscal federalism.

Poorer States are to receive a larger share of funds under the formula. Population is also taken into account because it reflects employment demand, and other socio-economic and governance indicators contribute as well.

Cost sharing is revised to encourage fiscal responsibility. Any expenditure beyond the approved normative allocation must be financed fully by the concerned State Government. The Draft Rules also set out the cost sharing for General States and for Northeastern and Himalayan States. A part of central assistance is linked to performance, judged on parameters such as timely wage payments and compliance with social audit requirements.

Planning under the programme is decentralised and technology-based.

Q1.

What does the acronym VB-G RAM G stand for?

- (A) Viksit Bharat — Gramin Rozgar Ajeevika Mission — Guarantee
- (B) Viksit Bharat — Guarantee for Rural Assets and Modernisation — Gramin
- (C) Viksit Bharat — Gramin Rural Ajeevika Mission — Guarantee
- (D) Viksit Bharat — Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin)

Q2.

Which programme under VB-G RAM G links employment generation with the creation of rural infrastructure?

- (A) PM Gati Shakti Rural Mission
- (B) Gramin Aajeevika Connectivity Programme
- (C) Viksit Bharat National Rural Infrastructure Stack Programme
- (D) Yuktdhara Infrastructure Stack

Q3.

Which plan is made mandatory under the Act's decentralised planning?

- (A) Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans
- (B) State Infrastructure Master Plans
- (C) District Employment Action Plans
- (D) National Rural Connectivity Plans

Q4.

Consider the following statements about VB-G RAM G:

- I. The Act is set to replace MGNREGA from July 2026.
- II. Preparation of Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans is mandatory.
- III. The Act does not include rural infrastructure among its objectives.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Consider the following statements about VB-G RAM G:

- I. Livelihood-supporting facilities are among the assets the infrastructure linkage covers.
- II. Climate resilience is among the stated objectives of the Act.
- III. The Act is set to replace the National Food Security Act.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

Which of the following is NOT stated as an objective of VB-G RAM G?

- (A) Generate productive employment
- (B) Strengthen rural infrastructure
- (C) Improve climate resilience
- (D) Promote urban metro expansion

VB-G RAM G: Governance and Transition

The Union Government has released Draft Rules under the VB-G RAM G Act. The programme is a Rural Employment and Livelihood Programme, and the Act is set to replace MGNREGA from July 2026. The Draft Rules therefore also address the move from the older scheme to the new framework.

The Draft Rules move away from an open-ended, demand-driven financing model towards a Normative Allocation Model. Central allocations are based on devolution criteria recommended by a Finance Commission, which is intended to make resource allocation predictable.

Performance is part of the funding design. A portion of central assistance depends on State performance from the second year onward, judged on timely wage payments, compliance with social audit requirements, completion rate of public works and overall implementation efficiency.

Cost sharing is also revised, with separate shares for General States and for Northeastern and Himalayan States. Any expenditure beyond the approved normative allocation must be financed fully by the concerned State Government.

The Act also provides for national-level bodies to oversee the programme, and the Draft Rules set out how MGNREGA job cards are handled in the transition.

Q1.

How many members does the National Level Steering Committee have?

- (A) 12
- (B) 16
- (C) 10
- (D) 20

Q2.

Which of the following is NOT a listed category of members of the National Level Steering Committee?

- (A) Representatives from State Governments
- (B) Officials from NITI Aayog
- (C) Representatives of relevant Union Ministries
- (D) Members of the Rajya Sabha

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. National Level Steering Committee	A. Advises the Centre on policy implementation
II. Central Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Council	B. Remain valid during the transition period
III. e-KYC verified MGNREGA Job Cards	C. Issued to workers subsequently
IV. Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Cards	D. Recommends State-wise allocations

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the national-level bodies under VB-G RAM G:

- I. The Steering Committee monitors implementation and compliance.
- II. The Council reviews programme performance.
- III. e-KYC verified MGNREGA Job Cards are cancelled at the start of the transition period.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the national-level bodies under VB-G RAM G:

- I. The Council is chaired by the Union Rural Development Secretary.
- II. The Steering Committee includes officials from NITI Aayog.
- III. The Council advises the Centre on policy implementation.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

Which minister chairs the Central Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Council?

- (A) Union Rural Development Secretary
- (B) Cabinet Secretary
- (C) Union Minister for Rural Development
- (D) Chairman, NITI Aayog

Recognition Criteria Practice (MCQ)

India runs a multi-party system, which the booklet contrasts with the one-party system of China and the two-party system of the USA. Parties are groups of like-minded individuals who voluntarily organise to gain political power through constitutional means and to promote the national interest. The Election Commission does not treat all parties alike. It classifies them as national parties or state parties, and each category is judged against its own set of criteria. Both categories are measured by the votes a party polls and the seats it wins at general elections to the Lok Sabha or the legislative assemblies. The booklet sets out the national party criteria first and the state party criteria after them. Across these tests, valid votes are counted either across several states or within a single state, and seats are counted either from one or more states, from a state's allotment, or in a state legislature. Recognised national and state parties are allotted a symbol that is exclusively reserved for their use in their respective jurisdiction. The booklet opens with a recent debate over the possible use of a cockroach as a political symbol, which drew attention to the framework governing election symbols. The booklet presents each category as a list of tests. Each test is written with a specific threshold, so the exact figures matter.

Q1.

What share of valid votes must a party poll in any four or more states at a general election to the LS or LA to qualify as a national party?

- (A) 2%
- (B) 6%
- (C) 8%
- (D) 10%

Q2.

From how many states must a national party win 2% of Lok Sabha seats at a general election?

- (A) Two
- (B) Four
- (C) Five
- (D) Three

Q3.

Under the state party criteria, one Lok Sabha seat is required for every how many seats, or any fraction thereof, allotted to the state?

- (A) 25
- (B) 10
- (C) 50
- (D) 100

Q4.

Assertion (A): Recognition of a party as a national or state party is linked to its results at general elections.

Reason (R): Recognition is granted to parties that win seats in state assemblies, with no vote-share test attached.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. National party: valid votes in any 4 or more states	A. 2% of Lok Sabha seats
II. National party: Lok Sabha seats from one or more states	B. 1 Lok Sabha seat
III. National party: Lok Sabha seat share from 3 states	C. 4 Lok Sabha seats
IV. State party: Lok Sabha seats per 25 allotted seats	D. 6% of valid votes

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. A national party may qualify by winning 4 seats in the Lok Sabha from one or more states.
- II. A state party may qualify by securing 6% of valid votes polled in the state at a general election to the LS from the state and winning 1 LS seat from that state.
- III. Recognition under these criteria is based on valid votes polled and seats won at general elections to the Rajya Sabha.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Read the statements below:

1. A state party may qualify by securing 8% of the total valid votes polled in the state at a GE to the LS or LA.
2. A national party may qualify by being recognised as a state party in 2 states.
3. A state party may qualify by winning 3% of LA seats or 3 seats, whichever is more.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

1968 Order Practice (MCQ)

Election symbols are part of India's multi-party system, which the booklet contrasts with the one-party system of China and the two-party system of the USA. A political party is described as a group of like-minded individuals who voluntarily organise to gain political power through constitutional means and to promote the national interest. A recent debate over the possible use of a cockroach as a political symbol drew attention to the framework that governs election symbols in India. That framework is the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, which provides the legal basis for how symbols are reserved and allotted. Parties and candidates do not all stand on the same footing under it. Recognised parties, whether national or state, are placed differently from parties that are registered but not recognised, and both differ from independent candidates. The booklet presents the framework in a short list of key points, starting with the basic legal structure of the Order. Each group has its own position, and the booklet explains these positions in a compact, ordered form. The booklet also places its material in a current affairs format, with a historical example and a set of practice questions at the end. The booklet is published as part of a monthly current affairs series.

Q1.

Which body issued the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order?

- (A) Parliament of India
- (B) Ministry of Law and Justice
- (C) Supreme Court of India
- (D) Election Commission of India

Q2.

Which of the following functions is NOT covered under the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order?

- (A) Registration and recognition of political parties
- (B) Classification of parties as national or state parties
- (C) Resolution of disputes from party splits and mergers
- (D) Regulation of election campaign expenditure

Q3.

Read the statements below:

1. The Order covers the registration of political parties.
2. The Order covers the derecognition of political parties.
3. The Order covers the allotment of free symbols by the Supreme Court.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q4.

How are free symbols allotted under the Order?

- (A) By the ECI from a notified list
- (B) By lottery among all applicants
- (C) By order of the Supreme Court
- (D) By a Parliamentary statute

Q5.

Assertion (A): The Order covers the classification of parties as national or state parties.

Reason (R): The Order covers the registration, recognition and derecognition of political parties.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Classification of parties	A. Party splits and mergers
II. Resolution of disputes from party splits	B. A notified list
III. Source of free symbols	C. Registered unrecognised parties and independent candidates
IV. Eligibility for free symbols	D. National or state party categories

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Order covers the resolution of disputes arising from party splits and mergers.
- II. Independent candidates may be allotted reserved symbols under the Order.
- III. Free symbols are available to registered unrecognised parties and independent candidates.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Constitutional basis and judicial review: MCQ

Digital speech has become a constitutional question in India, not only a matter of technology. In a recent episode, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology temporarily blocked the Telegram platform under Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, 2000. The action followed recommendations from the National Testing Agency, after criminal groups were said to have used the platform's message-editing features to target candidates appearing in NEET-UG 2026 Re-Examination. The episode raised a wider debate on how far the state may restrict online content. Coverage of the case also pointed to the platform's strong encryption and its support for very large file sharing. Government data indicates a sharp increase in cybercrime complaints linked to activities organised within Telegram groups. Telegram has been described as a platform that hosts active marketplaces for renting bank accounts used in money laundering, extortion and illegal gambling. The features being discussed include message editing, encryption and file

sharing. Such questions are examined in courts, where the powers and rules framed under the law are tested. Several High Courts and the Supreme Court have ruled on questions relating to blocking, and their decisions shape how the government, online platforms and users act when content is blocked. The Telegram case is therefore one example of a wider legal question.

Q1.

Under Section 69A, what kind of directions may be issued in urgent situations before a full review?

- (A) Permanent Blocking Orders
- (B) Show Cause Notices
- (C) Interim Blocking Directions
- (D) Suspension Notices

Q2.

In X Corp vs Union of India (2023), the Karnataka High Court ruled that which of the following cannot claim Article 19 rights to challenge blocking orders?

- (A) Foreign companies
- (B) Indian citizens
- (C) Parliamentary committees
- (D) Government departments

Q3.

In Shreya Singhal vs Union of India (2015), which provision did the Supreme Court strike down as vague?

- (A) Section 69A
- (B) Section 79(3)(b)
- (C) Section 79
- (D) Section 66A

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Delhi High Court in Tanul Thakur vs Union of India (2022) mandated disclosure of original blocking orders.

Reason (R): Article 19(2) allows the State to impose reasonable restrictions on free speech.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Shreya Singhal vs Union of India	A. Central Government or an officer specially authorised by it
II. Tanul Thakur vs Union of India	B. 2023
III. X Corp vs Union of India	C. 2015
IV. Section 69A	D. 2022

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Article 19(2) allows the State to impose reasonable restrictions on free speech.
- II. The Karnataka High Court held that Section 66A was unconstitutional.
- III. The Karnataka High Court held that foreign companies can claim Article 19 rights to challenge blocking orders.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I only

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Section 69A empowers the Central Government or an officer specially authorised by it to direct blocking of online information.
- II. Interim Blocking Directions may be issued in urgent situations before a Full Review.
- III. The Delhi High Court held that foreign companies cannot claim Article 19 rights to challenge blocking orders.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Intermediary duties and Safe Harbour: MCQ

Attention after the Telegram episode turned to the duties that online intermediaries owe under Indian law. The Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021 contain a set of such duties. They concern how platforms organise their internal structure, report on their activities and respond to unlawful content. These obligations sit alongside the Information Technology Act, 2000, which contains the main legal provisions on online information. Blocking under the Information Technology Act is governed by a separate set of procedures, and the Act also provides a mechanism for blocking public access to information. Telegram was temporarily blocked by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, following recommendations from the National Testing Agency. Criminal groups were reported to have used Telegram's message-editing features to target candidates appearing in NEET-UG 2026 Re-Examination. The episode also brought attention to the platform's encryption and its support for very large file sharing. Telegram has also been described as hosting marketplaces for renting bank accounts used in money laundering, extortion and illegal gambling. Government data indicates a sharp increase in cybercrime complaints linked to activities within Telegram groups. The Telegram case shows that platform features can become a matter of legal concern when they are misused. Section 79 of the Act is discussed alongside these duties.

Q1.

Through which government portal are orders issued under Section 79(3)(b) implemented?

- (A) DigiLocker Portal
- (B) UMANG Portal
- (C) Sahyog Portal
- (D) GeM Portal

Q2.

Which of the following is NOT one of the officers or contact persons that the IT Rules, 2021 require intermediaries to appoint?

- (A) Grievance Officer
- (B) Chief Compliance Officer
- (C) Nodal Contact Person
- (D) Chief Data Protection Officer

Q3.

Assertion (A): Intermediaries must appoint a Nodal Contact Person under the IT Rules, 2021.

Reason (R): Unlawful content must be removed on government direction.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Section 79(3)(b)	A. Must be removed on government direction
II. Sahyog Portal	B. Certain ministries can directly issue takedown or blocking orders
III. Section 79	C. Implements orders issued under Section 79(3)(b)
IV. Unlawful content	D. Immunity from liability for third-party content

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Intermediaries must appoint a Grievance Officer, a Chief Compliance Officer and a Nodal Contact Person under the IT Rules, 2021.
- II. Intermediaries must submit compliance and transparency reports once a year.
- III. Safe harbour under Section 79 is available only while intermediaries comply with lawful government directions.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Failure to comply with the duties can lead to loss of safe harbour under Section 79.
- II. Unlawful content must be removed on government direction.
- III. Orders under Section 79(3)(b) may be issued by any citizen.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

Under the IT Rules, 2021, how often must intermediaries carry out compliance and transparency reporting?

- (A) Weekly
- (B) Quarterly
- (C) Annually
- (D) Monthly

DPDP Act 2023 and privacy: MCQ

Personal information is now held by many mobile applications and online platforms. Indian law has dealt with privacy through court rulings and through a separate statute on personal data. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 is the statute that governs the processing of personal data in India. The Act followed years of discussion about how personal information should be protected. Personal data and facts were also described as an essential aspect of the right to privacy. Users are sometimes asked to give microphone or contact access to mobile applications. The Act sets out who is responsible for personal data and what rights individuals have in relation to it. Consumers and companies are both affected, since the Act changes what businesses can do with customer information. The Act also deals with how long platforms may hold data and when they must report breaches. The Act includes penalties intended to prevent misuse of personal data. The law also gives the government a role, including the power to obtain non-personal data from companies. The booklet links the Act to wider subjects such as the Right to Privacy and the EU's GDPR. The booklet presents these ideas in a short set of key terms and practical examples. The booklet also includes a table of definitions to help readers follow the terms used.

Q1.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Data Fiduciary	A. Processes data on behalf of the Data Fiduciary
II. Data Processor	B. Requires verified parental consent through technical measures
III. Critical personal data	C. Decides the purpose of processing personal data
IV. Child's data	D. Categories of data that require the most protection

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q2.

Under the DPDP Act 2023, within how many hours must a personal data breach be notified to the Data Protection Board?

- (A) Within 24 hours
- (B) Within 48 hours
- (C) Within 72 hours
- (D) Within 7 days

Q3.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 makes data fiduciaries accountable for personal data.
- II. Platforms may collect any data they wish, provided users accept their terms.
- III. All data is categorised under three heads: general, sensitive and critical.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) II and III only

Q4.

Assertion (A): A torch application on a mobile phone does not need microphone or contact access.

Reason (R): Platforms may collect only the data required for their functioning and for the services users have opted for.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

In 2017, the Supreme Court held that privacy is a fundamental right under which Article of the Constitution?

- (A) Article 14
- (B) Article 19(1)(a)
- (C) Article 21
- (D) Article 32

Q6.

Under the DPDP Act 2023, which term refers to the entity that processes personal data on behalf of the Data Fiduciary?

- (A) Data Principal
- (B) Data Processor
- (C) Data Custodian
- (D) Data Auditor

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. A Committee of Experts chaired by Justice BN Srikrishna examined data protection issues in India.
- II. E-commerce, social media and gaming platforms must generally delete personal data after 3 years of user inactivity.
- III. A Data Processor decides the purpose of processing personal data.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

WPI Basics: Index Revision Practice

Governments and analysts track changes in prices through a set of official price indices. The index known as WPI is treated as an important indicator of inflationary trends in the economy, and it is followed closely because it reflects price movements early in the chain of production and sale. The

Government of India has now approved a revision of the base year of this index. Along with the revised series, the government will introduce new indices for the first time. The revision also updates the methodology, including the weights used, the treatment of missing price data, and the classification of certain commodities. The aim of these changes is to make the index a more reliable guide to how sellers experience price movements. The revised structure is meant to reflect the present economy more accurately than the earlier series did.

Q1.

Consider the following statements about the WPI:

- I. It is released by the Reserve Bank of India.
- II. It captures prices after goods reach final consumers.
- III. It indicates inflationary trends within the production and distribution chain.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I and III only

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Full form of WPI	A. Production and distribution chain
II. Body that compiles and releases the WPI	B. Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade
III. Department under which that body works	C. Office of Economic Adviser
IV. Chain whose inflation trends the WPI indicates	D. Wholesale Price Index

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D

Q3.

At which level of trade are the WPI's goods priced?

- (A) Retail level
- (B) Export level
- (C) Wholesale or producer level
- (D) Household level

Q4.

Before the revision approved by the government, the WPI was based on which base year?

- (A) 2011-12
- (B) 2017-18
- (C) 2019-20
- (D) 2020-21

Q5.

Assertion (A): The WPI is an indicator of inflationary trends within the production and distribution chain.

Reason (R): The WPI measures retail prices paid by final consumers.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

At which point in the chain are the prices in this index recorded, relative to final consumers?

- (A) After goods are sold to final consumers
- (B) Only at the point of export
- (C) At the point of retail sale to households
- (D) Before goods reach final consumers

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The WPI captures prices before goods reach final consumers.
- II. The base year before the revision was 2011-12.
- III. The WPI is released by the Ministry of Finance.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

WPI and PPI: Feature Comparison Practice

Price data in India are released through more than one index, and two of them are compared on four features: scope, focus, perspective and purpose. A feature table is a useful way to read such comparisons, because it places the two measures side by side and shows where they differ.

The Government of India has approved a revision of the base year of one index, moving it to a newer reference period. Changing the base year is a technical step, but it affects how the index is read over time, so readers who compare old and new figures should keep the change in mind.

Each index has its own design, and the feature table shows how the two differ. The table has four rows, one for each feature, and two columns, one for each measure.

Because each measure has its own design, the two should not be treated as interchangeable. A reader who checks the table can see exactly where they differ and which question each measure is built to answer. The comparison discussed here is the feature table in the booklet's current affairs summary for June 2026.

Q1.

Which index has the perspective of producer revenue and input costs?

- (A) WPI
- (B) Consumer Price Index
- (C) PPI
- (D) Market-level price index

Q2.

What is the focus of the PPI, as compared with the WPI?

- (A) Wholesale price movements
- (B) Retail price movements
- (C) Export price trends
- (D) Producer-level price changes

Q3.

Assertion (A): The new Producer Price Indices are introduced alongside the revised WPI series.

Reason (R): The Service PPI captures inflation trends in the services sector from the producer perspective.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Focus of the WPI	A. Producer revenue and input costs
II. Perspective of the WPI	B. Wholesale price movements
III. Focus of the PPI	C. Market-level wholesale prices
IV. Perspective of the PPI	D. Producer-level price changes

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The Service PPI captures inflation trends in the services sector from the producer perspective.
- II. The WPI's scope is primarily goods.
- III. The PPI's stated purpose is inflation monitoring.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The WPI's focus is wholesale price movements.
- II. The PPI's perspective is market-level wholesale prices.
- III. The new PPIs are introduced alongside the revised WPI series.

How many of the statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only three
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Q7.

Which of these services is covered by the Service PPI?

- (A) Crude petroleum
- (B) Solar power
- (C) Primary articles
- (D) Railways

Evian Summit 2026 Practice

The Group of Seven, or G7, is described as an informal forum comprising some of the world's most advanced industrialised economies. It serves as a platform for consultations on major economic, political and strategic issues. Leadership of the forum rotates among its member states. The booklet says that discussions at the summit directly affect the development of financial regulations and economic frameworks used worldwide. Leaders also use the platform to coordinate on energy insecurity and geopolitical instability, and collective decisions of the G7 are said to influence global trade policies, investment flows and economic recovery strategies. The forum is also presented as a primary symbol of cooperation among the world's major economies. Its commitments are described as a catalyst for climate action and humanitarian assistance, and dialogue is said to help find common ground on complex global challenges. Current affairs material on the summit describes the event as one of a numbered series of meetings. The material also notes that the grouping's pillars of influence include its effect on regulation, its response to crises and its role in building consensus. The booklet is a current affairs tutorial, and it ends with practice questions on the summit, its history and its members. Those questions cover the forum's establishment, its member countries and the rotation of its presidency.

Q1.

In which city was the 2026 G7 Summit held?

- (A) Paris
- (B) Nice
- (C) Evian-les-Bains
- (D) Lyon

Q2.

Which phrase is the theme of the 2026 G7 Summit?

- (A) Forging New Partnerships and Rebuilding International Solidarity
- (B) Building a Sustainable Future Together
- (C) Resilient Democracies for a Peaceful World
- (D) Inclusive Growth and Global Cooperation

Q3.

At the 2026 summit, PM Modi took part in which session?

- (A) Plenary Session
- (B) Outreach Session
- (C) Finance Ministers' Track
- (D) Closing Retreat

Q4.

Read the assertion and reason and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): India's participation in the 2026 summit marked its first-ever participation in the G7 Outreach Process.

Reason (R): The invitation was recorded as marking India's consecutive participation in the G7 Outreach Process.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Edition of the 2026 summit	A. Evian-les-Bains
II. Host city of the 2026 summit	B. Eighth
III. Indian leader who attended the 2026 summit	C. 52nd
IV. India's consecutive participation count	D. PM Modi

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the 2026 summit:

- I. The summit was held in Paris, France.
- II. The summit's theme included the word 'Solidarity'.
- III. India's participation in the Outreach Process was its sixth consecutive one.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the statements below on the 2026 summit. How many of them are correct?

The summit was held in Evian-les-Bains, France.

PM Modi took part in the Outreach Session.

The summit was the 50th edition of the G7 Summit.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Pillars of G7 Influence Practice

The booklet on the G7 presents the forum's influence under several pillars, and gives each one a heading. Among the headings are Regulatory Influence, Collective Response to Crises, Driving Global Frameworks and Consensus-Building. The G7 is described as an informal forum comprising some of the world's most advanced industrialised economies, and it serves as a platform for consultations on major economic, political and strategic issues. The 2026 summit was held in Evian-les-Bains, and its theme was 'Forging New Partnerships and Rebuilding International Solidarity.' The booklet says that PM Modi attended the Outreach Session, and that the invitation marked India's eighth consecutive participation in the G7 Outreach Process. The booklet's title for this section is 'The Pillars of G7 Influence: Shaping the World Stage.' Each pillar is presented with its own heading and description. The booklet is a current affairs tutorial, and it ends with practice questions on the summit, its history and its members. Those questions cover the forum's establishment, its member countries and the rotation of its presidency. The material belongs to a June 2026 current affairs booklet that covers summits, reports and indices. The booklet's headings name the pillars that are used to explain the forum's influence. Pillar descriptions appear in a diagram-style layout, with each heading placed beside its text.

Q1.

On which two issues do G7 leaders use the platform to coordinate?

- (A) Energy insecurity and geopolitical instability
- (B) Visa rules and migration quotas
- (C) Naval construction and arms sales
- (D) Tariff rates and currency pegs

Q2.

Collective decisions of the G7 are said to influence which of the following?

- (A) Municipal budgets in member states
- (B) Membership rules of the United Nations
- (C) Domestic tax rates of non-member countries
- (D) Global trade policies, investment flows and economic recovery strategies

Q3.

What do dialogue and coordination help the G7 find on complex global challenges?

- (A) Binding military commitments
- (B) Common ground
- (C) Fixed national budgets
- (D) Unanimous trade bans

Q4.

Read the assertion and reason and choose the correct option.

Assertion (A): The forum is described as a primary symbol of cooperation among the world's smaller economies.

Reason (R): The forum fosters trust and partnership among the world's major economies.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Regulatory Influence	A. Commitments serve as a catalyst for climate action and humanitarian assistance
II. Collective Response to Crises	B. Leaders influence the evolution of governance to meet modern challenges
III. Driving Global Frameworks	C. Summit discussions shape financial regulations used worldwide
IV. Future-Proofing Governance	D. Enables a unified front in economic crises, armed conflicts and public health emergencies

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the statements below about the forum's influence:

- I. Summit discussions directly affect financial regulations used worldwide.
- II. The forum is described as a formal international organisation with a permanent secretariat.
- III. Commitments made during the summit serve as a catalyst for climate action and humanitarian assistance.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the statements below on the forum's influence. How many of them are correct?

The forum enables a unified front when addressing public health emergencies.

Leaders use the platform to coordinate on energy insecurity.

The forum is described as a symbol of rivalry between major economies.

- (A) Only three
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only two
- (D) All of the above

Maritime Cooperation: MCQ Practice

The 11th Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting was held in New Delhi, and maritime cooperation was one of the main strands of its outcomes. The booklet describes a joint approach to activity at sea, in which the grouping's members contribute to a shared picture of what happens on the water. The approach is presented as a way of improving the monitoring of the seas across the wider region. Naval work is another part of the Quad's activity. The Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission is listed among its major initiatives and is described as an effort to improve maritime coordination among the navies involved. Counterterrorism is also part of the agenda. A tabletop exercise on this subject is listed among the outcomes, and its focus includes planning for joint crisis response. The booklet gives the year in which the exercise is to take place, which is 2026. Data sharing is also among the outcomes, and the booklet lists it as part of the maritime agenda. The Quad's core objective is to promote a Free, Open, Inclusive, Secure and Prosperous Indo-Pacific region, based on the rule of law, freedom of navigation, territorial integrity and the peaceful resolution of disputes. The booklet presents these outcomes as the product of the 11th meeting.

Q1.

Under which declaration was the Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission launched?

- (A) Tokyo Declaration
- (B) Delhi Declaration
- (C) Wilmington Declaration
- (D) Sydney Declaration

Q2.

Which area is the immediate focus of the Indo-Pacific Maritime Surveillance Collaboration?

- (A) Arctic Ocean Region
- (B) Indian Ocean Region
- (C) Atlantic Ocean Region
- (D) Southern Ocean Region

Q3.

Assertion (A): The Quad's maritime surveillance framework does not draw on the assets of every member.

Reason (R): The framework uses the tracking and monitoring assets of all Quad members.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission	A. Near real-time maritime data sharing across regional waters
II. Malabar Exercise	B. Hosted by Australia in 2026
III. Indo-Pacific Partnership for Maritime Domain Awareness	C. Annual multilateral naval exercise of Quad members
IV. Quad Counterterrorism Tabletop Exercise	D. Launched under the Wilmington Declaration

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

Q5.

Which country will host the next edition of the Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission?

- (A) Japan
- (B) Australia
- (C) United States
- (D) India

Q6.

Consider the following statements about Quad maritime cooperation:

- I. The maritime surveillance framework uses tracking and monitoring assets of all Quad members.
- II. The immediate focus of maritime surveillance is the Arctic Ocean Region.
- III. The Malabar Exercise is an annual multilateral naval exercise of Quad members.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

How many of the following statements on maritime cooperation are correct?

- I. The Quad Counterterrorism Tabletop Exercise is to be hosted by Australia in 2026.
- II. The Indo-Pacific Partnership for Maritime Domain Awareness enables near real-time maritime data sharing.
- III. The Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission was launched under the Tokyo Declaration.
- IV. The Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission aims to counter illegal maritime activities.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Significance for India: MCQ Practice

The Quad brings together India, the United States, Japan and Australia. Its core objective is to promote a Free, Open, Inclusive, Secure and Prosperous Indo-Pacific region based on the rule of law, territorial integrity and the peaceful resolution of disputes. Its roots lie in humanitarian cooperation that followed the Indian Ocean Tsunami. The grouping was revitalised in 2017 amid concerns about China's expanding military and economic influence across the Indo-Pacific. The outcomes of the 11th meeting, held in New Delhi, cover several fields. Technology cooperation is one of them, and it extends across a range of digital and communications areas. The Quad is also presented as a provider of support to the region through a variety of initiatives. Economic work forms another field, and it is linked to reducing vulnerabilities in supply chains. For India, the booklet presents the Quad as a way to strengthen its role in the Indian Ocean Region. The grouping is said to help India monitor activity at sea more effectively. The booklet links these developments to the contemporary global order. The name Quad stands for Quadrilateral Security Dialogue. The booklet describes the Quad in terms of a partnership of four members, and its work spans several sectors, from naval activity to technology and supply chains. Within the wider region, the booklet also refers to a range of Quad Plus engagements.

Q1.

Which of the following is NOT listed among the regional public goods the Quad provides?

- (A) Disaster relief
- (B) Health security
- (C) Infrastructure support
- (D) Nuclear deterrence

Q2.

Which Chinese strategy in the Indian Ocean does the Quad help India balance?

- (A) Belt and Road
- (B) String of Pearls
- (C) Diamond Necklace
- (D) Open Door

Q3.

Apart from illegal fishing, which other activity does the Quad's enhanced maritime monitoring help India detect?

- (A) Grey-zone tactics
- (B) Ship-building disputes
- (C) Oil spills
- (D) Cloud seeding

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Quad helps India preserve its strategic autonomy.

Reason (R): The Quad enables deeper cooperation with major democracies without entering a formal military alliance.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Strategic counterbalance	A. 5G/6G and Open RAN networks
II. Technology cooperation	B. Diversification under the China+1 strategy
III. Regional public goods	C. Opposes unilateral attempts to alter the status quo
IV. Supply-chain resilience	D. Disaster relief and health security

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the Quad:

- I. The Quad helps India balance China's growing maritime presence.
- II. The Quad's technology cooperation includes secure digital infrastructure.
- III. The Quad's supply-chain work aims to increase dependence on dominant suppliers.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the Quad's significance are correct?

- I. The Quad's technology cooperation covers 5G/6G and Open RAN networks.
- II. The Quad is a formal military alliance.
- III. The Quad's supply-chain work supports diversification under the China+1 strategy.
- IV. The Quad lacks any technology cooperation agenda.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Benefits of Ethanol Blending: MCQ

Ethanol blending refers to mixing ethanol with petrol to create a fuel that is suitable for internal combustion engines. Ethanol is a highly purified alcohol, and the booklet notes that it can be produced from several major feedstocks, all of them crops that are rich in sugar or starch. The blending programme began as a pilot and has grown in scale over time. The benefits of the programme are discussed under three broad heads. The first head covers energy and economic gains, the second covers environmental gains, and the third covers agricultural and social gains. The booklet lists several points under each head, and each point is a short statement rather than a detailed analysis. The energy and economic head concerns the country's energy position and its economy. The environmental head concerns emissions linked to fuels. The agricultural and social head concerns farmers' income and the choice of crops that they grow. The booklet presents these benefits as the main reasons for promoting ethanol blending. It also records concerns about the programme, which are covered in a separate section of the same chapter. The chapter is part of a wider current affairs discussion on environment and disaster management, and it places the programme within that subject. The subject covers several other topics, but this passage deals only

with ethanol blending.

Q1.

According to the booklet, by how much does 2G ethanol reduce lifecycle GHG emissions compared to petrol?

- (A) Over 50%
- (B) About 10%
- (C) Over 20%
- (D) Over 80%

Q2.

Since which year have farmers earned about 21 lakh crore through ethanol procurement transfers?

- (A) 2003
- (B) 2014
- (C) 2018
- (D) 2023

Q3.

Assertion (A): Ethanol blending is promoted to lower greenhouse gas emissions by substituting fossil fuels.

Reason (R): Ethanol stockpiles provide flexibility for price stabilisation against crude oil shocks.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Agro-waste utilisation	A. Cuts dependence on crude oil imports
II. Blending buffer	B. Promotes cultivation of maize
III. Crop diversification	C. Stockpiles for price stabilisation against crude oil shocks
IV. Import reduction	D. Stubble, dung and biomass converted into fuel

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The ethanol blending programme was first launched as a pilot in 2003.
- II. One of its objectives is to provide assured markets for farmers.
- III. Sugarcane is the only major feedstock for ethanol.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q6.

How many of the following statements are correct?

1. The Ethanol Blending Programme was expanded under the National Policy on Biofuels, 2018.
 2. Ethanol blending is said to reduce maize cultivation in favour of sugarcane.
 3. Ethanol and biodiesel are named as the most common biofuels.
- (A) Only two
(B) Only one
(C) Only three
(D) All of the above

Q7.

Which of the following is NOT listed in the booklet as a major feedstock for ethanol?

- (A) Coal
(B) Maize
(C) Sugarcane
(D) Wheat

Concerns with Ethanol Blending: MCQ

Although the booklet describes ethanol blending as a policy with clear aims, it also records a number of concerns about the programme. These concerns fall into two broad groups. The first group concerns the experience of people who drive petrol vehicles, and the second concerns the effects of ethanol production on farming and natural resources. A survey is cited to show how petrol vehicle owners have been affected in everyday use. The owners described changes in how far their vehicles travel on a tank and in what they spend on upkeep. The booklet reports these changes as a concern for vehicle owners and presents the survey as its source. On the environmental side, the booklet points to the crops used for ethanol and to the way land is farmed. It notes that some crops need a large amount of water, and it refers to land that has lost its quality over time. The booklet presents these points as concerns linked to the programme. A further set of concerns relates to the use of some grains for fuel. The booklet lists this alongside the other points. The booklet presents these concerns as a counterpoint to the benefits of the programme, which are discussed separately in the same chapter.

Q1.

What percentage of petrol vehicle owners does the survey cited in the booklet report as having reduced mileage and higher maintenance costs?

- (A) 45%
(B) 57%
(C) 67%
(D) 76%

Q2.

Which crop's high water requirement is linked by the booklet to groundwater depletion?

- (A) Maize
(B) Wheat
(C) Pulses
(D) Sugarcane

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Water-intensive sugarcane	A. Food-versus-fuel concerns
II. Unsustainable farming	B. Groundwater depletion
III. Diverting rice and corn	C. Reduced mileage and higher maintenance costs
IV. Survey of petrol vehicle owners	D. Degradation of nearly 30% of India's land

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Sugarcane has a high water requirement, which the booklet links with groundwater depletion.
- II. Imports and food security concerns are listed among the issues with ethanol blending.
- III. Nearly 50% of India's land has been degraded by unsustainable farming.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- 1. Sugarcane needs very little water for cultivation.
- 2. Petrol vehicle owners in the survey reported higher maintenance costs.
- 3. Diverting rice and corn for ethanol raises food-versus-fuel concerns.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

Diverting which two crops for ethanol production is described as raising food-versus-fuel concerns?

- (A) Rice and corn
- (B) Wheat and barley
- (C) Sugarcane and jute
- (D) Millet and pulses

Biofuel Generations: MCQ

Biofuels are fuels made from biomass, and the booklet arranges them into groups called generations. The grouping depends on two things: the feedstock from which a fuel is made, and the amount of carbon that the fuel adds to the air. Because each group is defined by these features, the generations give a simple way to compare one biofuel with another. The booklet describes the groups one after another, beginning with the earliest and moving to newer groups that draw on different inputs and processes. The groups differ in their feedstock and in the carbon impact they are said to have, and the booklet gives a separate account of each one. Biofuel policy is discussed in the same part of the booklet. The National Policy on Biofuels is the framework that the booklet cites, and it aims to reduce import dependence through fuel blending and related production. The accounts are brief, and each one names the feature that separates that group from the others. The

booklet uses the terms carbon neutral and carbon negative for two of the groups. Carbon neutral is explained as a case where the carbon emitted equals the carbon sequestered, and the booklet presents this as a feature of one group.

Q1.

How many of the following statements are correct?

1. First-generation biofuel has a high carbon content.
 2. Fourth-generation biofuel is described as carbon neutral.
 3. Third-generation biofuel is produced using algae, which are microorganisms.
- (A) Only one
(B) Only two
(C) Only three
(D) All of the above

Q2.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The National Policy on Biofuels includes production of 2G ethanol as a key element.
- II. Third-generation biofuel is made from leftovers of food crops.
- III. Second-generation biofuel has a higher greenhouse gas content than first-generation biofuel.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
(B) I and II only
(C) II and III only
(D) I and III only

Q3.

Where is the first 2G Ethanol Project mentioned in the booklet located?

- (A) Panipat, Haryana
(B) Jaipur, Rajasthan
(C) Nagpur, Maharashtra
(D) Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. First generation	A. Made from genetically engineered crops
II. Second generation	B. Produced using microorganisms such as algae
III. Third generation	C. Made from edible items such as sugar, corn and starch
IV. Fourth generation	D. Made from leftovers of food crops such as rice husk and wood chips

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
(B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
(C) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
(D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q5.

Assertion (A): Third-generation biofuel is described as carbon neutral.

Reason (R): Fourth-generation biofuel is made from genetically engineered crops.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
(B) A is true but R is false
(C) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
(D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

The first-generation biofuel is made from which of the following?

- (A) Leftover food crop residues
- (B) Algae and microorganisms
- (C) Edible items such as sugar, corn and starch
- (D) Genetically engineered crops

Q7.

Which generation of biofuel is described as carbon negative?

- (A) First generation
- (B) Second generation
- (C) Third generation
- (D) Fourth generation

WED and UNEP: MCQ practice

The booklet describes several environmental programmes in India, and this passage draws on a few of them. The Swachh Bharat Abhiyan was launched by the Prime Minister on Gandhi Jayanti in New Delhi, with the aim of making a Clean India by a date that marked the 150th birth anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi. Over the years, the mission has evolved into a National Movement. India's Plastics Pact is the first of its kind in Asia and was launched in collaboration with the Confederation of Indian Industries and the World Wide Fund for Nature. It is a business-led initiative that seeks to transform the plastics packaging value chain for all formats and products. The Aravalli Green Wall Project draws its inspiration from Africa's Great Green Wall and proposes a green belt of 1,400 km by 5 km along the Aravalli Range. Its purposes include halting desertification from the Thar Desert and improving air quality and biodiversity. Its other stated purposes are restoring degraded lands and ecosystems and building climate resilience. Mission LiFE is another initiative that was first introduced by the Prime Minister at COP 26 in Glasgow. It is described as an India-led global mass movement that aims to nudge individual and collective action to protect and preserve the environment.

Q1.

On which date is World Environment Day celebrated every year?

- (A) April 22
- (B) May 22
- (C) June 5
- (D) June 16

Q2.

In which year was World Environment Day established to coincide with the opening of the Stockholm Conference on Human Environment?

- (A) 1970
- (B) 1972
- (C) 1973
- (D) 1975

Q3.

Which of the following is stated as a purpose of World Environment Day?

- (A) Raising awareness and driving global action on pressing environmental issues
- (B) Setting a binding plastic treaty for all member states
- (C) Launching the International Solar Alliance
- (D) Raising the climate finance target to \$2 trillion

Q4.

Assertion (A): The United Nations Environment Programme organises World Environment Day.

Reason (R): The United Nations Environment Programme is based in Nairobi, Kenya.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

I. UNEP was founded in 1972.

II. The headquarters of UNEP is in Geneva, Switzerland.

III. Brazil was named Global Host for World Environment Day 2026.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I, II and III
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I only

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Global Host for World Environment Day 2026	A. June 5
II. Headquarters of UNEP	B. Only One Earth
III. Theme celebrated in 1973	C. Nairobi, Kenya
IV. Date of World Environment Day	D. Azerbaijan

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

I. The 2026 theme of World Environment Day is 'Inspired by Nature. For Climate. For Our Future.'

II. World Environment Day is organised by UNEP.

III. The 2026 theme of World Environment Day is 'Ecosystem Restoration'.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Climate finance and the TFFF: MCQ practice

The booklet describes a new arrangement that serves as a modern foundational pillar for global climate finance. It sets an overarching target for scaling up climate funding to developing nations. The Tropical Forest Forever Facility is a separate vehicle that directly addresses the financial drivers of deforestation. Its focus is on tropical forests. India's climate commitments take a different form. Its Nationally Determined Contributions set targets on emissions intensity, non-fossil power capacity and carbon sinks. The updated submission made in 2022 raised the goals for 2030. The booklet also lists the UNFCCC, the carbon market, and Article 6 and 6.4 of the Paris Agreement under its skill-up heading. The International Solar Alliance was launched by India and France at COP-21 in Paris. The Alliance covers solar resource-rich States that lie between the

Tropic of Cancer and the Tropic of Capricorn. Under the heading India's Contribution Towards Environmental Sustainability, the booklet lists the National Mission for Green India, introduced in 2014 as one of the missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change. The mission aims to increase forest and tree cover on 5 million hectares. The mission also aims to improve the quality of forest and tree cover on another 5 million hectares.

Q1.

At which climate summit was the New Collective Quantified Goal on climate finance formally established?

- (A) COP26 in Glasgow
- (B) COP28 in Dubai
- (C) COP29 in Baku
- (D) COP30 in Belém

Q2.

What per-year climate funding target has been set for developing nations by 2035?

- (A) \$800 billion
- (B) \$1.3 trillion
- (C) \$500 billion
- (D) \$2 trillion

Q3.

How much have developed nations agreed to lead in annual mobilisation by 2035?

- (A) \$100 billion
- (B) \$200 billion
- (C) \$500 billion
- (D) \$300 billion

Q4.

Assertion (A): COP30 in Belém is widely termed the 'Amazon Forest COP'.

Reason (R): Belém is a city in Brazil.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Target for developing nations' climate funding per year by 2035	A. COP29 in Baku
II. Developed nations' annual mobilisation by 2035	B. COP30 in Belém
III. Formal establishment of the NCQG	C. \$300 billion
IV. Official launch of the TFFF	D. \$1.3 trillion

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The TFFF makes standing, living tropical forests more economically valuable than cleared land.
- II. COP30 in Belém is widely termed the 'Amazon Forest COP'.
- III. Developed nations agreed to lead mobilisation of at least \$1.3 trillion annually by 2035.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I only

Q7.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The NCQG on climate finance was formally established at COP29 in Baku.
- II. The TFFF was officially launched at the G20 Summit in New Delhi.
- III. Developed nations agreed to lead mobilisation of at least \$300 billion annually by 2035.

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

India's NDC targets and the ISA: MCQ practice

India's national climate commitments are called Nationally Determined Contributions, and they set targets on emissions intensity, non-fossil power capacity and carbon sinks. The National Mission for Green India was introduced in 2014 as one of the missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change. Its aim is to increase forest and tree cover on 5 million hectares of land, and to improve the quality of forest and tree cover on another 5 million hectares. The Aravalli Green Wall Project is inspired by Africa's Great Green Wall. It proposes a green belt of 1,400 km by 5 km along the Aravalli Range, running from Porbandar in Gujarat to Panipat in Haryana. Its purposes include halting desertification from the Thar Desert and restoring degraded lands and ecosystems. The project also aims to improve air quality, biodiversity and climate resilience. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management and Planning Authority, known as CAMPA, has funds aimed at promoting afforestation and regeneration activities on waste, vacant and barren lands. Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam is a campaign that asks people to plant trees in memory of their mother, linking an emotional appeal with afforestation. India's Plastics Pact is the first of its kind in Asia. It is a business-led initiative.

Q1.

In which year did India submit its updated NDC?

- (A) 2022
- (B) 2015
- (C) 2020
- (D) 2030

Q2.

By how much did India's updated NDC propose to cut emissions intensity of GDP by 2030, from 2005 levels?

- (A) 33-35%
- (B) 40%
- (C) 45%
- (D) 50%

Q3.

On which date was the International Solar Alliance officially established?

- (A) 6 December 2015
- (B) 12 December 2017
- (C) 6 June 2017
- (D) 6 December 2017

Q4.

Assertion (A): The International Solar Alliance covers solar resource-rich States lying between the Tropics of Cancer and Capricorn.

Reason (R): The ISA was jointly launched by India and France in 2015.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. First NDC: emissions intensity target for 2030	A. 50%
II. Updated NDC: emissions intensity target for 2030	B. 40%
III. First NDC: non-fossil capacity target for 2030	C. 33-35%
IV. Updated NDC: non-fossil capacity target for 2030	D. 45%

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-C, IV-B
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The first NDC, submitted in 2015, set a target of 40% non-fossil fuel based installed electric power capacity by 2030.
- II. The updated NDC, submitted in 2022, set a 2030 target of a 33-35% cut in emissions intensity of GDP.
- III. The ISA was officially established on 6 December 2017.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I only
- (D) I, II and III

Western Ghats and Space Science

Ecologically Sensitive Areas are zones that the government can notify to protect the natural environment. Once an area is notified, activities that could harm its ecology are regulated, with the aim of conserving biodiversity, forests, wildlife habitats and water resources. Such areas can include forests, biodiversity hotspots, rivers, hills and wetlands. These regions are notified by the environment ministry under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986, and the process moves in stages. The Western Ghats, a long range of hills along India's west coast, have been the subject of such a proposal for many years, and the notification is now being prepared. Recommendations made earlier have shaped the proposal. Within these areas, sustainable livelihoods, eco-tourism, traditional agriculture and conservation-based practices are generally allowed. Environmental

rules can restrict some heavy-impact activities while leaving room for practices that are less damaging to the land. Space science also draws attention in India. Scientists use ground-based observatories to study particles that arrive from outer space, and collaborations between research teams help them follow changes in the planet's atmosphere. Meanwhile, international reports measure how countries are moving toward energy systems that are secure, sustainable, equitable and affordable. These developments show how environmental protection, scientific research and energy planning appear together in current affairs.

Q1.

Which committee's 2013 recommendations form the basis of the government's proposed notification of Ecologically Sensitive Areas in the Western Ghats?

- (A) Madhav Gadgil Committee
- (B) Cabinet Secretary-led committee
- (C) K. Kasturirangan Committee
- (D) Joint Parliamentary Committee

Q2.

The Kasturirangan approach covers roughly what share of the Western Ghats?

- (A) About 37%
- (B) About 52%
- (C) About 60%
- (D) About 25%

Q3.

Which institution operates the GRAPES-3 cosmic-ray observatory?

- (A) Indian Space Research Organisation
- (B) Bhabha Atomic Research Centre
- (C) Indian Institute of Science
- (D) Tata Institute of Fundamental Research

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Western Ghats are known as the 'Water Tower of Peninsular India'.

Reason (R): The Western Ghats are the source of major rivers such as the Godavari, Krishna and Cauvery.

- (A) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Anamudi	A. Also known as the Sahyadri Range
II. GRAPES-3	B. Assessment of 120 countries
III. Energy Transition Index 2026	C. Cosmic-ray observatory at Ooty
IV. Western Ghats	D. Highest peak of the range, located in Kerala

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (B) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements about Ecologically Sensitive Areas:

- I. The Western Ghats are a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
- II. Organic farming and rainwater harvesting are permitted activities in these areas.
- III. All large construction projects are permitted in these areas.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the Western Ghats:

- I. The range extends about 1,600 km along India's west coast.
- II. The range spans eight states.
- III. New thermal power plants are restricted in Ecologically Sensitive Areas.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

FCRA Rules and Global Bodies

The Ministry of Home Affairs has notified new rules for non-governmental organisations that receive contributions from abroad. The rules aim at stricter compliance, transparency and monitoring, and they operate under a law meant to protect India's sovereignty, integrity, security and national interest. Organisations seeking such funds must have their activities placed under defined categories, and they must disclose details about their work, the states where they operate and their public outreach. Certain persons in leadership roles are also covered, as the rules widen the definition of who manages an organisation. Funds are linked to utilisation as well, so an organisation's record of spending earlier money affects whether it receives more. The governing law is also meant to stop foreign money from being used for religious conversion. Separately, an intergovernmental body works against money laundering and the financing of terrorism, and its lists of countries under scrutiny carry different implications for access to financial markets. India also takes part in United Nations peacekeeping, where troops and police are deployed to regions affected by conflict or political instability. Such missions have been recognised with a Nobel Peace Prize, and their personnel are often called Blue Helmets. The broader picture shows how domestic regulation and global cooperation both shape the way resources and peace efforts move across borders.

Q1.

NGOs must utilise at least what share of previously released foreign funds before receiving the next instalment?

- (A) 50%
- (B) 60%
- (C) 90%
- (D) 75%

Q2.

For how long is an FCRA registration valid before it must be renewed?

- (A) Three years
- (B) Five years
- (C) Seven years
- (D) Ten years

Q3.

Which grouping of countries created the Financial Action Task Force in 1989?

- (A) G7
- (B) G20
- (C) BRICS
- (D) SAARC

Q4.

Assertion (A): Foreign contributions cannot be passed on to other persons or organisations.

Reason (R): The FCRA (Amendment) Act 2020 prohibits transfer or sub-granting of foreign contributions to any other person or organisation.

- (A) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (B) A is true but R is false
- (C) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Grey List	A. US-led initiative for secure AI-critical supply chains
II. Black List	B. Calls for protecting women and girls from conflict-related sexual violence
III. Pax Silica	C. Jurisdictions under increased monitoring
IV. Principles of the 2000 UN Security Council Resolution	D. High-risk jurisdictions

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Vivek Aggarwal has been appointed as the next Vice-President of the FATF, the first time India will hold that post.
- II. The FCRA Act, 2010 replaced the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act, 1976.
- III. NGOs with any foreign national as a key functionary are automatically eligible for FCRA registration.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I, II and III
- (C) I and II only
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. India joined the Pax Silica initiative in February 2026.
- II. The International Day of UN Peacekeepers is observed on 24 October.
- III. India was the first country to deploy an all-women contingent to a UN peacekeeping mission.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only two
- (B) Only one
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Padma Awards and University Rankings

India's civilian honours recognise achievement across many fields, and the President confers them at a ceremony at Rashtrapati Bhavan. The Padma honours are among the best known of these, and they are given after a multi-stage process. The Padma Vibhushan is India's second highest civilian honour, after the Bharat Ratna. Recommendations come from a committee, the proposals are reviewed at the top level of government, and the final approval rests with the head of state. The Constitution abolishes titles, but the Supreme Court has upheld the Padma honours as recognition of merit and public service rather than as titles, and recipients may not use them as prefixes or suffixes to their names. Government servants are generally not eligible, though doctors and scientists are an exception. The government also honours children each year for achievements in fields such as bravery, innovation and sports, through an award presented at Vigyan Bhawan. University rankings attract similar attention. Such rankings are built on several parameters, including reputation among academics and employers, research output and the share of international students and faculty. The methodology weighs each parameter, so the total score depends on how each parameter is weighted. Both subjects appear in the same part of the current affairs coverage.

Q1.

What is the annual maximum number of Padma Awards that may be conferred?

- (A) 100
- (B) 110
- (C) 120
- (D) 131

Q2.

In which year were the Padma Awards instituted?

- (A) 1947
- (B) 1950
- (C) 1955
- (D) 1954

Q3.

The PM Rashtriya Bal Puraskar was created in 2018 by merging which two earlier awards?

- (A) Padma Shri and Padma Bhushan
- (B) Bal Kalyan Puraskar and Bal Shakti Puraskar
- (C) Padma Vibhushan and Bharat Ratna
- (D) Bal Shakti Puraskar and Padma Shri

Q4.

Assertion (A): Foreign nationals are ineligible for Padma Awards.

Reason (R): Foreign nationals are excluded from the annual cap on Padma Awards.

- (A) A is false but R is true
- (B) Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Padma Vibhushan	A. Distinguished contributions and achievements in any discipline or area of public life
II. Padma Bhushan	B. Children aged 5 to 18
III. Padma Shri	C. Distinguished service of a high order in any field
IV. PM Rashtriya Bal Puraskar	D. Exceptional and distinguished service of the highest order

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (D) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C

Q6.

Consider the following statements about Padma Awards:

- I. The Padma Awards selection committee is chaired by the Cabinet Secretary.
- II. Padma Awards are announced annually on the eve of Independence Day.
- III. A recipient normally needs at least five years to elapse before being considered for a higher Padma category.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

Consider the following statements about QS World University Rankings 2027:

- I. The rankings were released by Quacquarelli Symonds.
- II. Academic Reputation carries a weight of 30% in the ranking methodology.
- III. Employer Reputation carries a weight of 25% in the ranking methodology.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Type-in-the-answer passages

Strategic benefits: short answers

Supporters of the June 2026 understanding argue that its benefits would reach well beyond the two signatories. A safer environment in the region could lower the likelihood of direct military clashes and of confrontations fought through allied groups. Calmer conditions would also make oil supplies more dependable, and lower crude prices could ease the financial strain on countries that import

most of their energy. Shipping costs could fall as insurers judge a critical route to be less risky, and investment could flow back into areas hit by conflict, helping to rebuild them. New trade links could also connect the markets of West and Central Asia, and the reintegration of the country could give a north-south transport corridor a fresh boost. Yet the outlook is not uniform. Some analysts doubt that the parties can settle every disputed issue in the time allowed. Meanwhile, tensions involving regional proxies remain. Balancing these hopes against those risks will shape whether the accord delivers lasting dividends for the wider region.

Q1.

Under which strategic pillar is 'energy market benefits', including reduced oil price volatility, listed? Give the pillar number.

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which strategic pillar covers stimulated trade and investment? Give the pillar number.

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which waterway's reopening reduces freight and insurance costs for shipping?

Answer: _____

Q4.

The reintegration of which port is linked to a boost for the International North-South Transport Corridor (INSTC)?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Experts doubt a comprehensive settlement can be concluded within what timeframe, in months?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Persistent regional tensions with Israel are linked to which group, named in the booklet?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Lower crude oil prices would lower the inflationary pressures and current account deficit of which country?

Answer: _____

Strategic Ties TITA

Myanmar holds a special place in India's foreign policy. It is the only ASEAN nation with which India shares a boundary, and the two countries are linked by both land and sea. The land frontier runs through several northeastern states, where cross-border issues such as insurgency, narcotics trafficking and illegal arms smuggling have long been concerns. Cooperation with Myanmar is therefore seen as critical for tackling these problems. Myanmar also lies near India's island territories, which makes maritime cooperation important for regional stability and security. Beyond security, Myanmar acts as a bridge between South Asia and South-East Asia, a role that matters for India's connectivity with the wider region. India seeks to enhance its ties with Myanmar in line with its Act East and Neighbourhood First policies. Myanmar's membership of several regional forums adds to its importance for India. Trade is an important part of this relationship, and the Kaladan project and the trilateral highway are central to plans for better physical links. The relationship has deep roots in history, as the modern boundary was shaped by a treaty that ended an early nineteenth-century war.

Q1.

In which year did India and Myanmar sign their Treaty of Friendship? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the length of the India-Myanmar land border? (in km)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which trade agreement governs bilateral trade between India and Myanmar? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Myanmar is an observer in which South Asian grouping? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q5.

From which Indian town in Manipur does the India-Myanmar-Thailand Trilateral Highway start?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Along which sea does the India-Myanmar maritime boundary lie? (name)

Answer: _____

Council of Ministers and Key Rules

The Prime Minister is the head of the Union Government and leads the Council of Ministers. The Council is the body through which the government functions, and the Prime Minister acts as its chief coordinator for government policy and administration. Ministers are placed at different levels. Cabinet ministers are the senior members, and they often oversee key ministries such as Home Affairs, Finance and Defence. Ministers of State assist Cabinet ministers with specific functions, and some of them are given independent charge of a ministry. Deputy Ministers help Cabinet ministers or Ministers of State with administrative, political and parliamentary duties. This structure allows policy decisions to pass through senior leaders before they reach individual departments. The Constitution sets out the office of the Prime Minister, the Council of Ministers and the relationship between them and the President. At the state level, a similar arrangement exists, with a Chief Minister heading the council and advising the Governor. Students should learn which constitutional provisions govern these arrangements, and how the rules connect to the everyday working of the government.

Q1.

Which Article of the Constitution deals with the appointment, tenure and responsibilities of the Prime Minister and the Council of Ministers? (give the article number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under which Article can ministers take part in the proceedings of both Houses of Parliament without a guaranteed right to vote? (give the article number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under the 91st Amendment (2003), what is the maximum size of the Council of Ministers as a share of the total strength of the Lok Sabha? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q4.

After how many months out of Parliament does a minister lose their position? (in months)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Article provides for State Councils of Ministers led by the Chief Minister to assist and advise the Governor? (give the article number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which Prime Minister of India is described in the booklet as the first PM of South Indian origin, from Andhra Pradesh? (give full name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Prime Minister is described in the booklet as India's first Sikh PM? (give full name)

Answer: _____

Citizenship Law Framework

Indian citizenship is governed by a set of constitutional and statutory rules rather than by any single certificate. The Constitution, through a group of early articles, settled who became a citizen when the Republic began. Those articles were not meant to be read alone, because the detailed rules on how citizenship is gained and lost are set out in a separate law passed by Parliament. That law has changed over the decades. It has been amended several times since the 1980s, reflecting shifts in policy on illegal migration and on the status of migrants from neighbouring countries. Earlier changes altered the basis of citizenship, moving the regime toward a principle linked to parentage. Later changes eased the path for certain religious communities who had entered India from neighbouring countries before a fixed date. Some features of the system are firm. India does not allow a person to hold citizenship of another country alongside Indian citizenship. The law also sets out the circumstances in which citizenship can be lost. Officials and students alike should note that the rules fix who is a citizen, while documents only record or support that status. Keeping this distinction clear helps explain why a passport, a voter card or an identity number cannot by itself settle a citizenship question.

Q1.

How many times has the Citizenship Act, 1955 been amended since 1986? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did the Citizenship (Amendment) Act shift India's citizenship regime towards Jus Sanguinis?

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many communities are granted citizenship under the Citizenship (Amendment) Act 2019? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

On or before which date must migrants have entered India to be covered by the Citizenship (Amendment) Act 2019?

Answer: _____

Q5.

On which date (day and month, 1950) did the citizenship provisions in Articles 5 to 11 take effect?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the first of the three conditions listed for losing citizenship under the Citizenship Act, 1955? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Apart from birth, descent, registration and naturalisation, what is the fifth way of acquiring citizenship under the Citizenship Act, 1955? (a short phrase)

Answer: _____

Allocation and Cost-Sharing Check

The Draft Rules for the VB-G RAM G Act 2025 change how central money reaches states for rural employment. Under the earlier scheme, funding followed an open-ended, demand-driven model. Under the new approach, central allocations are set by a normative allocation formula. This formula is based on devolution criteria recommended by a finance commission and uses several weighted factors. One factor measures how far a state's per capita income lags behind that of the wealthiest states. Another reflects population and the employment demand that comes with it. The aim is to give economically weaker states a larger share and to promote equitable distribution.

Cost sharing is also revised. General States share costs with the Centre in one ratio, while Northeastern and Himalayan States receive a higher central share. Any expenditure beyond the approved normative allocation must be fully financed by the concerned state government. Central assistance is also linked to performance. From a later year of implementation, a portion of funds depends on timely wage payments, compliance with social audit requirements, completion of public works and overall implementation efficiency.

A National Level Steering Committee oversees these matters. It recommends state-wise allocations, formulates operational standards and monitors implementation and compliance.

Q1.

Within how many days of completing work must wage payment be made under the VB-G RAM G Act? (Give the number of days.)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What weightage (in per cent) is given to GSDP distance in the Normative Allocation Formula?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What weightage (in per cent) is given to population in the Normative Allocation Formula?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What share of cost (in per cent) does the Centre bear for General States?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What share of cost (in per cent) does the Centre bear for Northeastern and Himalayan States?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which Union official chairs the National Level Steering Committee?

Answer: _____

Party Splits Recall

Political parties are not always stable. A party may split when its members disagree, and each resulting group may claim to be the real party. When this happens, the question of who keeps the party's name and symbol becomes a dispute. Only one authority is empowered to decide such disputes, and it does not rely on a single measure of support. It looks at the backing a faction has among the party's office holders and executive members, and also at the support it has among the party's elected legislators. Majority support in both areas is treated as important. Historically, one such case involved a major national party that split, after which two new groups were recognised. The outcome of a dispute can take several forms. One faction may keep the name and symbol, while the other must register separately under a new name and a different symbol. Where neither faction can show that it commands a majority, the original symbol may be put on hold, and both groups are directed to contest under new names and symbols. Disputes arising from mergers of parties fall within the same authority's role. Courts have also been drawn into these matters, and their decisions have shaped how the tests are applied. The range of possible outcomes shows how much depends on the result of a dispute.

Q1.

In which year did the Election Commission of India issue the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year did the split in the Indian National Congress occur that led ECI to recognise Congress (O) and Congress (R)? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which wing of a party includes its president, office bearers and national and state executive members? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which 1972 Supreme Court case held that majority support must be determined in both the organisational and legislative wings? (name of the first-named party)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which 1986 case held that the Symbols Order is a valid exercise of ECI's constitutional and statutory powers? (name of the first-named party)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Under the state party criteria, what percentage of valid votes polled in the state must a party secure, along with winning 2 seats in the state legislative assembly? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q7.

If split factions reunite later, what may they approach the ECI for? (a short phrase)

Answer: _____

Section 69A: powers and safeguards

Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, 2000 is the main legal mechanism the government uses to restrict access to digital content and online platforms in India. It empowers the Central Government, or an officer it specially authorises, to direct any government agency or intermediary to block public access to online information. Requests for blocking are examined under the Information Technology (Blocking Rules) through a structured review process. Before a proposed action is put into effect, it is checked for its necessity and legality. In urgent situations, however, the government may act before a full review is completed, provided the action is examined later. Blocking decisions must fall within specific grounds that concern the nation, its security, and public peace. These grounds include the sovereignty and integrity of India, the defence of India, and public order. The power is meant to deal with organised crime and harmful content online, but it must also respect constitutional freedoms and judicial scrutiny. Such a framework helps the state balance security concerns with the rights of individuals and platforms. Many disputes over blocking have reached the courts, which have examined both the powers and the safeguards. Officials who use the power and platforms that receive such directions are both expected to follow the prescribed procedure carefully.

Q1.

In which year was Section 69A introduced? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year is the set of IT (Blocking Rules) that governs blocking requests dated? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Name the review mechanism through which blocking requests are examined under the IT (Blocking Rules).

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which committee evaluates the necessity and legality of a proposed blocking action before it is implemented?

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many grounds for blocking under Section 69A are listed in the booklet? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Under which Article of the Constitution is digital free speech protected? (article number with sub-clause)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Supreme Court case upheld Section 69A as a narrowly drawn provision? (case name)

Answer: _____

Producer Indices: Typed Answer Practice

Most discussion of inflation focuses on the prices that households pay, yet the prices that producers receive and pay also shape the economy. Policymakers therefore need measures that show price movements from the producer's side of the chain. Economic activity today is also not limited to physical goods. The service sector is also part of economic activity, and a separate Service Producer Price Index tracks its prices. A measure that covers only goods can leave

important producer-side changes out of view. To address such gaps, the Government has decided to introduce a new family of producer indices alongside the revised wholesale index. The indices are intended to capture price changes at different stages of production and across services as well. They are also expected to help analysts understand cost conditions and supply-side pressures faced by businesses. Because producers operate in many sectors, a broader set of indices allows a more detailed reading of how cost and revenue pressures move through the economy. Such information can help central planners, investors and industry bodies anticipate changes in inflation before they fully appear in consumer prices.

Q1.

For the first time, dedicated Producer Price Indices will be released with which base year? (give the year range)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many distinct types of Producer Price Index are described in the booklet? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Producer Price Index measures changes in prices paid by producers for inputs used in production? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many services are listed in the booklet as covered by the Service PPI? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In the WPI vs PPI comparison, which index has a scope covering both goods and services? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In the WPI vs PPI comparison, which index has the stated purpose of inflation monitoring? (one word)

Answer: _____

Membership and Structure Check

The Group of Seven is an informal forum that brings together some of the world's most advanced industrialised economies. Its purpose is to serve as a platform for consultations on major economic, political and strategic issues facing the world today. Because it is informal, it does not function like a treaty-based international organisation with binding rules. Instead, its members meet to share views, compare national positions and look for common ground. Several other actors take part in the group's deliberations, including international bodies that are closely involved in its discussions, although they do not share the same status as the core members. The forum is led in turn by its members, so that each country takes its turn at hosting and guiding the agenda for a set period before handing over responsibility to the next. This system of rotation ensures that leadership is shared and that different national priorities are represented over time. Successive leaders have shaped the forum's agenda since it was formed. Each feature of the forum, including its composition, its rotating leadership and its informal nature, helps explain how the grouping works in practice. Its ability to bring together major economies also gives its discussions weight across many policy areas.

Q1.

How many countries are listed as formal member countries of the G7? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What share of the world's population do G7 countries account for, approximately? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What share of global GDP do G7 countries account for, approximately? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which regional bloc takes part in G7 deliberations without being counted as a formal member?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which country will take over the G7 rotating presidency in 2027?

Answer: _____

Q6.

How often does leadership of the G7 rotate among member states? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which member country holds the G7 presidency for 2026? (one word)

Answer: _____

Economy and technology: typed answers

Economic security has become a central part of the Quad's agenda. Members have recognised that depending on a small number of suppliers for essential raw materials can create supply vulnerabilities, so they are working to spread sources more widely. Cooperation now spans the full life cycle of key minerals, from mining and processing to recycling, with the aim of making supply less exposed to shocks.

Energy is another priority. The group has agreed to a joint regional approach that links energy technology, supply chain strength and the assessment of market risks. This work is meant to help countries across the Indo-Pacific manage market risks.

The Pacific islands are also part of the agenda. A planned outreach effort aims to link island nations of the Pacific Islands Forum through a more robust network and to modernise ports, with completion targeted for the near term.

On technology, the Quad is developing practical tools for digital systems. Officials are preparing a reference document that will help public and private platforms work with one another across borders. A separate initiative uses artificial intelligence, robotics and remote sensing to support farming and food security. Together these efforts seek to make growth in the region both secure and resilient.

Q1.

Which Quad initiative aims to enhance agricultural productivity and food security across the Indo-Pacific? (Give the initiative's name.)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What is the name of the technical tool being developed for Digital Identity Systems to improve cross-border interoperability?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Quad energy initiative launched a Joint Regional Energy Roadmap? (Give the initiative's name.)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What type of network is the Pacific Island Infrastructure Outreach planned to use to connect all Pacific Island Forum countries?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Along with the Supply Chain Resilience Initiative, which network is credited with helping India attract foreign investment?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which Quad framework coordinates investments and policies on mining, processing and recycling of critical minerals? (Give the framework's name.)

Answer: _____

Policies and Schemes Check

India's biofuel effort rests on several policy instruments. The National Policy on Biofuels aims to reduce import dependence by promoting blends of bioethanol, biodiesel and bio-CNG. One scheme provides financial assistance for second-generation ethanol made from surplus biomass and agricultural waste. Another scheme focuses on managing cattle dung and solid waste on farms and turning them into useful products. A separate policy aims to create bio-foundries that would produce biotechnology-developed feedstock and catalysts, and planned enzyme production would support existing and proposed ethanol plants in several states. India also joined partners to launch an alliance focused on sustainable biofuels and cooperation between countries. Another initiative aims to build an ecosystem that collects used cooking oil and converts it into biodiesel. The Cabinet has approved a hydrogen mission with targets for green hydrogen capacity, renewable energy capacity addition and jobs. Taken together, these measures show how biofuel policy spans agriculture, energy, waste management and international cooperation. Policy design in this area also looks at farm residue, since stubble and dung can be turned into fuel and compost.

Q1.

In which year did the Cabinet approve the Hydrogen Mission?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What was the outlay of the Hydrogen Mission, in crore rupees?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which Haryana town is the first BioE3 enzyme plant expected to come up?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the PM JI-VAN Yojana launched?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Under which mission was the GOBAR-DHAN Scheme launched?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which authority launched the Repurpose Used Cooking Oil initiative?

Answer: _____

Q7.

The Global Biofuels Alliance was launched on the sidelines of which summit?

Answer: _____

Plastics, Cleanliness and Mission LiFE

Plastic pollution is a pressing environmental problem, and governments are negotiating a legally binding agreement to end it worldwide. A dedicated negotiating committee has been meeting for this purpose, holding its sessions in different countries as the talks progress. India has added its own domestic efforts. A cleanliness campaign that began as a national drive has grown into a mass movement with the aim of building a clean and green India. Business and conservation groups have also joined hands in a plastics pact that seeks to transform the packaging value chain across all formats and products. A project called REPLAN works on the same problem from another direction, collecting waste plastic and processing it so that it can be turned into something useful. Mission LiFE, described as an India-led global mass movement, encourages individuals and communities to take small, sustainable actions that protect the environment. The mission also sets targets for villages and urban local bodies to become environment-friendly, showing that ambition is set at the local level as well as the national level. Together, these initiatives show that solving plastic pollution requires government negotiations, industry commitment, local innovation and changes in everyday habits.

Q1.

Which city in Uruguay hosted the first session (INC-1) of the plastic pollution negotiating committee in 2022?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was Mission LiFE first introduced by PM Modi at COP26?

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many billion Indians and other global citizens is Mission LiFE aiming to mobilise for 2022-2027? (in billion)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which country was the first in the world to ban thin plastic bags?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which body launched Project REPLAN? (give the abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which country was the third session (INC-3) on plastic pollution held in 2023?

Answer: _____

Industry, Ports and Infrastructure

India's industrial and infrastructure indicators drew attention this month. The Index of Industrial Production (IIP) recorded a growth of 4.9 per cent in April 2026, lower than the 5.8 per cent growth registered in April 2025. Manufacturing, which carries a large share of the index, expanded by 6.2 per cent, while mining and quarrying contracted. Alongside this, the government released a revised IIP series with 2022-23 as the new base year, replacing the earlier 2011-12 base.

On the logistics front, India released its Logistics Port Performance Index for FY 2024-25 along with four new digital governance initiatives. The index evaluates ports across dry bulk, liquid bulk and container cargo. Its key performance indicators include vessel turnaround time, berth idle time and container dwell time. The framework was developed by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways.

Road connectivity also advanced, as the Zojila Tunnel crossed a 13 km excavation milestone. The tunnel is part of an all-weather road link between Kashmir and Ladakh. The revised IIP series retains mining and quarrying, manufacturing and electricity as traditional sectors, while adding new activities such as gas supply, water supply and waste management. Electricity generation is now classified separately into renewable and non-renewable sources, which sharpens the picture of industrial output.

Q1.

What is the total length of the Zojila Tunnel (in km)?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year is the Zojila Tunnel expected to become operational?

Answer: _____

Q3.

How many item groups are covered in the revised IIP series?

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many products are covered in the revised IIP series?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which port topped the liquid bulk category of the Logistics Port Performance Index FY 2024-25?

Answer: _____

Q6.

India's rank in the international shipments category of the World Bank Logistics Performance Index improved from which rank?

Answer: _____

Q7.

How many Indian ports featured among the world's top 100 in the Container Port Performance Index 2024?

Answer: _____

Iran-U.S. Accord and Its Aftermath

Iran and the United States have been locked in a long dispute over Iran's nuclear programme. For years the country lived under extensive sanctions, which shaped its economy and its relations with the wider world. A later accord was struck between Iran and a set of major world powers. In 2018, the United States left the agreement. Iran responded by reducing its adherence to several of the commitments it had made. The Islamabad Memorandum of Understanding, signed in June 2026, is an interim diplomatic framework rather than a permanent peace treaty. Its fourteen points cover an immediate end to hostilities, restoration of commercial navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, and discussions on sanctions relief. The memorandum also includes oversight of implementation, the release of frozen funds and a proposal for a comprehensive agreement backed by the UN Security Council once negotiations conclude. Iran has reaffirmed its nuclear pledge under the document, which also includes a commitment to refrain from nuclear weapon development. Phased sanctions relief and easing of restrictions on Iranian oil exports are also part of the arrangement under discussion.

Q1.

In which year was the agreement between Iran and the major powers concluded?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Iran's 2015 agreement was concluded with which group of countries? Give the short form.

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under the JCPOA, Iran agreed to restrict which activity?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under the JCPOA, what did Iran agree to reduce?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Under the JCPOA, which kind of inspections did Iran agree to permit?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Iran's scaled-back JCPOA compliance related mainly to uranium enrichment and which other area?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the common abbreviation of the Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action?

Answer: _____

The IAEA and the Iran Dispute

The International Atomic Energy Agency works in the field of nuclear energy and is headquartered in Vienna, Austria. It was founded in 1957. The agency's stated purpose is to promote the peaceful use of nuclear energy. It has become visible in the current dispute between Iran and the United States. The Islamabad Memorandum of Understanding, signed in June 2026, provides for downblending of highly enriched uranium under IAEA supervision. The booklet describes that memorandum as an interim diplomatic framework rather than a permanent peace treaty. Its fourteen points include an immediate end to hostilities, restoration of commercial navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, and confidence-building measures between both countries. The memorandum also envisages a comprehensive agreement backed by the Security Council once negotiations conclude. Iran has reaffirmed its nuclear pledge under the document, which also

includes a commitment to refrain from nuclear weapon development. The memorandum also calls for the lifting of naval restrictions and the restoration of unrestricted commercial maritime traffic through the Strait of Hormuz. Discussions on nuclear issues, regional security and sanctions relief are part of the wider process that follows these initial steps. Restricted assets are to be unlocked under the memorandum, and oversight of implementation is part of the same document.

Q1.

In which year was the IAEA awarded the Nobel Peace Prize?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the speech that gave rise to the IAEA delivered?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Who is the current head of the IAEA?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What type of organisation is the IAEA? Give two words.

Answer: _____

Q5.

The IAEA's objective includes inhibiting the use of nuclear energy for what purpose?

Answer: _____

Q6.

To which UN body was the 'Atoms for Peace' speech delivered?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the name of the 1953 speech from which the IAEA grew?

Answer: _____

Yandaboo Treaty Facts

Myanmar's President made a five-day official visit to India, his first since the political transition in 2021. The visit fits into India's Neighbourhood First Policy, Act East Policy and wider Indo-Pacific vision. The booklet calls Myanmar India's only ASEAN neighbour, connected to India through both land and maritime routes, and describes it as a geographic bridge to Southeast Asia. Looking back, a large part of one Indian region lay under the rule of a neighbouring kingdom for an extended period. That arrangement ended with a treaty named after a place, the Treaty of Yandaboo. Representatives of two powers signed it. The same treaty brought an end to a war fought between those powers. The visit's outcomes included security cooperation, the Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport Project and the Trilateral Highway. The booklet also refers to the Rupee-Kyat settlement mechanism, which has been operational since 2024. The booklet's historical context section begins with the treaty and its effects on Indian territory, and it presents this background as the context for the present visit. Myanmar's links to India's Act East Policy are discussed in the same opening section. The booklet's account of the treaty is short, and it then moves on to the outcomes of the visit.

Q1.

In which year was the Treaty of Yandaboo signed?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which years did the war that the treaty ended take place? (give both years)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Representatives of which two parties signed the treaty? (name both)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What did the treaty establish between India and Myanmar? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which war did the treaty bring to an end? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Under whose control was a large part of an Indian region before the treaty? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Indian region was under that control before the treaty? (name)

Answer: _____

Connectivity Projects Recap

Connectivity was one of the subjects linked to the visit made by Myanmar's President to India. The visit's outcomes included two connectivity projects. The first is a multi-modal transit transport project, which combines different modes of transport to link India with Myanmar. The second is a trilateral highway that connects India, Myanmar and Thailand by road. The highway begins on the Indian side, runs into Myanmar and continues on to Thailand. The booklet describes Myanmar as central to India's Neighbourhood First Policy and Act East Policy, and it describes the country as a link between India and Southeast Asia. Both countries discussed the transit project during the visit, and the highway was also part of those discussions. Myanmar's regional importance, as the booklet explains, rests on its land and maritime links with India. The booklet also mentions an assurance from Myanmar that its territory would not be used by anti-India insurgent groups. The booklet lists both projects among the outcomes, and it presents them as part of the broader relationship between the two countries, which also covers security cooperation and the Indo-Pacific vision. The visit was the first official visit by Myanmar's President to India since the 2021 political transition, a point the booklet states at the start of its coverage.

Q1.

Which Thai town does the Trilateral Highway reach? (name of town)

Answer: _____

Q2.

The booklet describes Myanmar as a geographic ___ linking India with Southeast Asia. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

The Trilateral Highway runs from the border at Tamu to which two Myanmar towns? (name both)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What did both countries reaffirm about the multi-modal transit project? (phrase)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the name of the multi-modal transit transport project? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Myanmar is India's only neighbour in which regional grouping? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Ministers and Appointment Rules

The Constitution provides for the appointment of the Prime Minister by the President, but the President's choice is shaped by the political situation in the Lok Sabha. Normally, the leader of the majority party is invited to form the government. When no party has a clear majority, the President looks for a person who can attract support from a combination of parties. The Prime Minister heads the government and guides its policy. Ministers are then chosen to help run the government, and the booklet lists several categories among them. Some ministers hold independent charge of ministries, while others assist senior ministers in their work. A minister who is not a member of Parliament has a limited time to become one. The booklet also notes that ministers may take part in the proceedings of both Houses without a guaranteed right to vote. The size of the council is restricted by a constitutional amendment, and the salary of the Prime Minister is set by law. Constitutional provisions on these matters are set out in several Articles, which the booklet links to each rule. The booklet also describes the Prime Minister as the head of the executive and the leader of the Council of Ministers. Together, these points give a basic picture of how the executive functions at the Union level.

Q1.

What is the minimum number of parties that the person invited by the President must be able to command support of, when no single party has a clear majority? (number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which group of ministers assists Cabinet Ministers or Ministers of State with administrative, political and parliamentary duties?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Union body does the Prime Minister chair, according to the booklet's key functions? (name of body)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Name the first key ministry the booklet lists among those overseen by Cabinet Ministers.

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which group of ministers is described as senior members of the Council of Ministers, placed below the Prime Minister?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which house of Parliament has had a member made Prime Minister in some cases? (name of house)

Answer: _____

Modi's Records in Context

Narendra Modi has been Prime Minister since 26 May 2014, and his uninterrupted service has drawn attention in the booklet. The booklet also places him in a wider context of Prime Ministers who came from different backgrounds. Some of them took office at a young age, while others were very old when they became Prime Minister. A few Prime Ministers left office in unusual ways, and some held the post for only a very short time. The Lok Sabha has 543 seats, and the booklet records how many of those seats the 2014 alliance won. Several Prime Ministers also came from South India, and their origins are noted in the booklet. The booklet presents these details in short factual notes, which makes it possible to compare the careers of different leaders. The booklet also records that Jawaharlal Nehru was India's first Prime Minister and that Lal Bahadur Shastri was the second to die in office. Its notes on Nehru also mention that his overall tenure is recorded as about 6,131 days, including his period as interim Prime Minister before the first general elections. Taken together, the examples show the range of experience among India's Prime Ministers and the variety of paths they followed to office.

Q1.

In the 2014 Lok Sabha election, how many seats did the BJP-led NDA win? (number of seats, out of 543)

Answer: _____

Q2.

The booklet describes Modi as the first Indian PM born after which date? (full date)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which PM is described in the booklet as India's youngest PM, at 40 years? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

At what age, in years, is the booklet's oldest Prime Minister, Morarji Desai, described as being?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which PM is described in the booklet as the first PM to leave office following a no-confidence vote? (full name, initials allowed)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many days was the tenure of the PM the booklet describes as having the shortest tenure? (number of days)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which PM is described in the booklet as India's 2nd PM of South Indian origin, from Karnataka? (full name)

Answer: _____

VB-G RAM G: Governance and Transition

The Union Government has released Draft Rules under the VB-G RAM G Act, which is set to replace MGNREGA from July 2026. The programme is a Rural Employment and Livelihood Programme, and

the Draft Rules describe how it will be run.

The Draft Rules move away from an open-ended, demand-driven financing model towards a Normative Allocation Model. Central allocations are based on devolution criteria recommended by a Finance Commission, which is meant to make resource allocation predictable.

Performance is part of the funding design. A portion of central assistance depends on State performance from the second year, judged on timely wage payments, compliance with social audit requirements, completion rate of public works and overall implementation efficiency.

Cost sharing is also revised, with separate shares for General States and for Northeastern and Himalayan States. Any expenditure beyond the approved normative allocation must be financed fully by the concerned State Government.

The Act also provides for national-level oversight of the programme. The Draft Rules set out how MGNREGA job cards are handled during the transition period.

Q1.

How many members does the National Level Steering Committee have?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which minister chairs the Central Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Council? (Give the designation.)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What type of verification must MGNREGA job cards have to remain valid during the transition period?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What card will workers subsequently receive under the new framework? (Give the full name.)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Officials from which body are members of the National Level Steering Committee?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which body advises the Centre on policy implementation? (Give the full name.)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which committee recommends State-wise allocations?

Answer: _____

Recognition Criteria Practice (TITA)

India runs a multi-party system, which the booklet contrasts with the one-party system of China and the two-party system of the USA. Parties are groups of like-minded individuals who voluntarily organise to gain political power through constitutional means and to promote the national interest. The Election Commission does not treat all parties alike. It classifies them as national parties or state parties, and each category is judged against its own set of criteria. Both categories are measured by the votes a party polls and the seats it wins at general elections to the Lok Sabha or the legislative assemblies. The booklet sets out the national party criteria first and the state party

criteria after them. Across these tests, valid votes are counted either across several states or within a single state, and seats are counted either from one or more states, from a state's allotment, or in a state legislature. Recognised national and state parties are allotted a symbol that is exclusively reserved for their use in their respective jurisdiction. The booklet opens with a recent debate over the possible use of a cockroach as a political symbol, which drew attention to the framework governing election symbols. The booklet presents each category as a list of tests. Each test is written with a specific threshold, so the exact figures matter.

Q1.

How many Lok Sabha seats must a national party win from one or more states? (number)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What percentage of total valid votes polled in a state must a state party secure at a general election to the LS or LA? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under the state party criterion based on seats, what fixed minimum number of LA seats applies whichever is more than 3% of seats? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

A state party wins one Lok Sabha seat for every how many seats, or any fraction thereof, allotted to the state? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

How many Lok Sabha seats must a state party win from the state, along with securing 6% of valid votes in the state at a GE to the LS from that state? (number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

From how many states must a national party win 2% of Lok Sabha seats at a general election? (number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What percentage of valid votes must a national party secure in any four or more states at a general election? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

1968 Order Practice (TITA)

Election symbols are part of India's multi-party system, which the booklet contrasts with the one-party system of China and the two-party system of the USA. A political party is described as a group of like-minded individuals who voluntarily organise to gain political power through constitutional means and to promote the national interest. A recent debate over the possible use of a cockroach as a political symbol drew attention to the framework that governs election symbols in India. That framework is the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, which provides the legal basis for how symbols are reserved and allotted. Parties and candidates do not all stand on the same footing under it. Recognised parties, whether national or state, are placed differently from parties that are registered but not recognised, and both differ from independent candidates. The booklet presents the framework in a short list of key points, starting with the basic legal structure of the Order. Each group has its own position, and the booklet explains these positions in

a compact, ordered form. The booklet also places its material in a current affairs format, with a historical example and a set of practice questions at the end. The booklet is published as part of a monthly current affairs series.

Q1.

Which body issued the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order? (abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q2.

What category of symbols is allotted by the ECI from a notified list? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Besides party splits, which other event does the Order's dispute resolution cover? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which function of the Order is the opposite of recognition? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which wing includes elected MPs, MLAs and MLCs in the ECI's party-split tests? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In the Congress split example, what does the R in Congress (R) stand for? (one word)

Answer: _____

Constitutional basis and judicial review: TITA

India's rules on online speech sit at the meeting point of technology and fundamental rights. The government can ask platforms to stop public access to certain online content, and the law lets it act on recommendations made by agencies. In a recent case, a messaging platform was temporarily blocked after criminal groups reportedly exploited its features to defraud candidates. The Telegram episode also drew attention to the platform's encryption, its file-sharing capacity and its message-editing features, which were discussed in coverage of the case. Government data also indicates a sharp increase in cybercrime complaints linked to activities organised within such groups. The platform is also described as hosting marketplaces for renting bank accounts used in money laundering. The legal basis for the power is an Act passed in 2000, and its wording has been examined several times. Courts have heard petitions about the way blocking orders reach the people affected, and about the confidentiality attached to them. Rulings by the Supreme Court and several High Courts have therefore become important reference points. Their decisions show that some provisions have been struck down while others have survived. Companies based abroad have also tested whether they can claim the same constitutional protections as Indian entities. Understanding these rulings helps explain why the blocking process is shaped by both statute and judgment.

Q1.

In which year did the Supreme Court decide *Shreya Singhal vs Union of India*? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which High Court ruled in *X Corp vs Union of India* (2023) that foreign companies cannot claim Article 19 rights to challenge blocking orders? (name of court)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which High Court mandated disclosure of original blocking orders in Tanul Thakur vs Union of India (2022)? (name of court)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What term describes the directions that may be issued in urgent situations before a full review under Section 69A? (three words)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Article of the Constitution allows the State to impose reasonable restrictions on free speech? (article number with sub-clause)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In Shreya Singhal vs Union of India (2015), which section of the IT Act did the Supreme Court strike down as vague? (section number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which year did the Delhi High Court mandate disclosure of original blocking orders? (year)

Answer: _____

Intermediary duties and Safe Harbour: TITA

Following the Telegram action, the discussion widened to the responsibilities that digital intermediaries carry under Indian law. These responsibilities are set out in the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021, which sit alongside the Information Technology Act, 2000. The Rules deal with the way platforms organise their internal functions, report on their activities and deal with content that is found to be unlawful. Compliance machinery matters because the Rules tie platform obligations to specific roles. The Telegram episode showed that features such as message editing can be used to spread misleading material after an event. Telegram was temporarily blocked by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology after recommendations from the National Testing Agency. Fraudsters are also reported to have inserted fake exam papers into old messages to create the appearance of a leak. Telegram is also described as hosting marketplaces for renting bank accounts used for money laundering. Government data has also pointed to a sharp rise in cybercrime complaints linked to activities organised within such groups. Hidden phone numbers and end-to-end encryption in secret chats were highlighted as making it nearly impossible for investigators to trace malicious actors. The Telegram case therefore brings together three themes: platform features, intermediary duties and the powers of the state.

Q1.

Through which government portal are orders under Section 79(3)(b) implemented? (portal name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Under which section of the IT Act do online intermediaries get immunity from liability for third-party content? (section number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which officer must intermediaries appoint to handle grievances under the IT Rules, 2021? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How often must intermediaries carry out compliance and transparency reporting under the IT Rules, 2021? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which officer must intermediaries appoint for compliance under the IT Rules, 2021? (three words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which contact person must intermediaries appoint under the IT Rules, 2021? (three words)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under Section 79, protection from liability for third-party content is available only if intermediaries exercise what? (two words)

Answer: _____

DPDP Act 2023 and privacy: TITA

Personal information now passes through many hands, from mobile applications to online services and social platforms. Concern about this flow of information led to a long debate in India about how personal data should be protected. A committee of experts was set up to examine these issues and submitted its report and a draft bill to the ministry responsible for electronics and information technology. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 is the framework that now applies to personal data. Under the Act, those who decide why personal data is processed are made accountable for it. Individuals also have a role, since they can withdraw consent and ask for access to or deletion of their information. The Act also distinguishes between kinds of data, with some categories needing stronger protection. The booklet explains these terms in a table, which helps readers match each term to its meaning. The Act is discussed in relation to the right to privacy, which the courts have recognised. Penalties also form part of the Act, and their purpose is described as preventing misuse of personal data. The booklet also lists the Right to Privacy and CERT among related topics for further study. The booklet gives an everyday example of a torch application on a mobile phone.

Q1.

In which year did the Supreme Court hold that privacy is a fundamental right under Article 21? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who chaired the Committee of Experts that examined data protection issues in India? (name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under the DPDP Act 2023, what is the term for the entity that processes personal data on behalf of the Data Fiduciary? (term)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under the DPDP Act 2023, within how many hours must a personal data breach be notified to the Data Protection Board? (number of hours)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the draft Personal Data Protection Bill submitted along with the Committee of Experts' report? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

After how many years of user inactivity must e-commerce, social media and gaming platforms generally delete personal data? (number of years)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the name of the category of data that requires the most protection under the DPDP Act 2023? (three words)

Answer: _____

WPI and PPI: Names and Phrases

A feature table is a helpful way to read such comparisons, since it places each measure side by side and makes differences easier to see. The table has four rows, one for each feature, and two columns, one for each measure. The four features are scope, focus, perspective and purpose. Scope refers to what the measure covers, focus refers to the kind of price movement it follows, perspective refers to the vantage point from which prices are viewed, and purpose refers to the question the measure is designed to answer. The Government of India has approved a revision of the base year of one of these indices. Changing the base year is a technical step, but readers who compare old and new figures should keep it in mind. The revised series is to be released along with new measures that give a fuller view of price changes faced by businesses. Because each measure has its own design, the two should not be treated as interchangeable. A reader who checks the feature table can see where they differ and which question each measure is built to answer. The comparison is taken from the booklet's current affairs summary for June 2026.

Q1.

Which index has a perspective of producer revenue and input costs? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Name the service covered by the Service PPI that concerns rail transport. (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which index has a scope that is primarily goods? (acronym)

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the stated purpose of the PPI in the comparison? (name the phrase)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What is the stated focus of the PPI? (name the phrase)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the stated focus of the WPI? (name the phrase)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which PPI covers inflation trends in the services sector from the producer perspective? (name the PPI)

Answer: _____

Evian Summit 2026 Recall

The Group of Seven, or G7, is described as an informal forum comprising some of the world's most advanced industrialised economies. The forum is also presented as a primary symbol of cooperation among the world's major economies. Its commitments are described as a catalyst for climate action and humanitarian assistance, and dialogue is said to help find common ground on complex global challenges. The booklet says that discussions at the summit directly affect the development of financial regulations and economic frameworks used worldwide. Leaders also use the platform to coordinate on energy insecurity and geopolitical instability, and collective decisions of the G7 are said to influence global trade policies, investment flows and economic recovery strategies. It serves as a platform for consultations on major economic, political and strategic issues. Leadership of the forum rotates among its member states. Current affairs material on the summit describes the event as one of a numbered series of meetings. The material also notes that the grouping's pillars of influence include its effect on regulation, its response to crises and its role in building consensus. The booklet is a current affairs tutorial, and it ends with practice questions on the summit, its history and its members. Those questions cover the forum's establishment, its member countries and the rotation of its presidency.

Q1.

In which city was the 2026 G7 Summit held? (city name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which numbered edition of the G7 Summit is the 2026 one? (number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which word completes the 2026 theme 'Forging New Partnerships and Rebuilding International ___'? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which Indian Prime Minister took part in the 2026 summit? (surname)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which session of the 2026 summit did India's Prime Minister join? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which ordinal number of consecutive participation did the 2026 invitation mark for India? (number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the name of the G7 process in which India's participation is counted? (two words)

Answer: _____

Maritime Cooperation: TITA Practice

The 11th Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting was held in New Delhi, and maritime cooperation was one of the main strands of its outcomes. The booklet describes a joint approach to activity at sea, in which the grouping's members contribute to a shared picture of what happens on the water. The approach is presented as a way of improving the monitoring of the seas across the wider region. Naval work is another part of the Quad's activity. The Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission is listed among its major initiatives and is described as an effort to improve maritime coordination among the navies involved. Counterterrorism is also part of the agenda. A tabletop exercise on this subject is listed among the outcomes, and its focus includes planning for joint crisis response. The booklet gives the year in which the exercise is to take place, which is 2026. Data sharing is also among the outcomes, and the booklet lists it as part of the maritime agenda. The Quad's core objective is to promote a Free, Open, Inclusive, Secure and Prosperous Indo-Pacific region, based on the rule of law, freedom of navigation, territorial integrity and the peaceful resolution of disputes. The booklet presents these outcomes as the product of the 11th meeting.

Q1.

Which country is to host the Quad Counterterrorism Tabletop Exercise in 2026?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which annual multilateral naval exercise of Quad members is named in the outcomes? (Give the name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Through which partnership is near real-time maritime data shared across regional waters? (Give the full name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under which declaration was the Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission launched? (Give the name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Besides naval coordination, what capability does the Quad-at-Sea mission aim to enhance? (One word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which country will host the next edition of the Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Besides illicit maritime activities, what other kind of threat does the maritime surveillance objective aim to monitor? (One word)

Answer: _____

Benefits of Ethanol Blending: Typed Answer

Ethanol blending refers to mixing ethanol with petrol to create a fuel that is suitable for internal combustion engines. Ethanol is a highly purified alcohol, and the booklet notes that it can be

produced from several major feedstocks, all of them crops that are rich in sugar or starch. The blending programme began as a pilot and has grown in scale over time. The benefits of the programme are discussed under three broad heads. The first head covers energy and economic gains, the second covers environmental gains, and the third covers agricultural and social gains. The booklet lists several points under each head, and each point is a short statement rather than a detailed analysis. The energy and economic head concerns the country's energy position and its economy. The environmental head concerns emissions linked to fuels. The agricultural and social head concerns farmers' income and the choice of crops that they grow. The booklet presents these benefits as the main reasons for promoting ethanol blending. It also records concerns about the programme, which are covered in a separate section of the same chapter. The chapter is part of a wider current affairs discussion on environment and disaster management, and it places the programme within that subject. The subject covers several other topics, but this passage deals only with ethanol blending.

Q1.

In which year was the Ethanol Blending Programme first launched as a pilot?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Apart from sugarcane, which crop does the booklet say crop diversification promotes?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Since 2014, farmers have earned about how many lakh crore through ethanol procurement transfers? Give the number only.

Answer: _____

Q4.

What term does the booklet use for an economy in which stubble, dung and biomass are converted into fuel?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Ethanol stockpiles provide flexibility for stabilising what, against crude oil shocks?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Under which policy was the Ethanol Blending Programme expanded? Give the year of the policy only.

Answer: _____

Concerns with Ethanol Blending: Typed Answer

Although the booklet describes ethanol blending as a policy with clear aims, it also records a number of concerns about the programme. These concerns fall into two broad groups. The first group concerns the experience of people who drive petrol vehicles, and the second concerns the effects of ethanol production on farming and natural resources. A survey is cited to show how petrol vehicle owners have been affected in everyday use. The owners described changes in how far their vehicles travel on a tank and in what they spend on upkeep. The booklet reports these changes as a concern for vehicle owners and presents the survey as its source. On the environmental side, the booklet points to the crops used for ethanol and to the way land is farmed. It notes that some crops need a large amount of water, and it refers to land that has lost its quality over time. The booklet presents these points as concerns linked to the programme. A further set of concerns relates to the use of some grains for fuel. The booklet lists this alongside the other points. The booklet presents these concerns as a counterpoint to the benefits of the programme, which are

discussed separately in the same chapter.

Q1.

What is the approximate water requirement range of sugarcane, in tonnes per tonne?

Answer: _____

Q2.

What percentage of petrol vehicle owners reported reduced mileage in the survey? Give the number only.

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which resource is said to be depleted by water-intensive sugarcane?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which two crops, when diverted for ethanol, raise food-versus-fuel concerns?

Answer: _____

Q5.

What broad term describes the concern that food crops are used for fuel?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which broader issue, listed together with imports, is a concern for the ethanol programme?

Answer: _____

Biofuel Generations: Typed Answer

Biofuels are fuels made from biomass, and the booklet arranges them into groups called generations. The grouping depends on two things: the feedstock from which a fuel is made, and the amount of carbon that the fuel adds to the air. Because each group is defined by these features, the generations give a simple way to compare one biofuel with another. The booklet describes the groups one after another, beginning with the earliest and moving to newer groups that draw on different inputs and processes. The groups differ in their feedstock and in the carbon impact they are said to have, and the booklet gives a separate account of each one. Biofuel policy is discussed in the same part of the booklet. The National Policy on Biofuels is the framework that the booklet cites, and it aims to reduce import dependence through fuel blending and related production. The accounts are brief, and each one names the feature that separates that group from the others. The booklet uses the terms carbon neutral and carbon negative for two of the groups. Carbon neutral is explained as a case where the carbon emitted equals the carbon sequestered, and the booklet presents this as a feature of one group.

Q1.

On what date is World Biofuel Day observed? Give the day and month.

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which generation of biofuel is produced using microorganisms such as algae?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which generation of biofuel is made from genetically engineered crops?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Name one food-crop leftover, besides wood chips, used to make second-generation biofuel.

Answer: _____

Q5.

The National Policy on Biofuels lists the production of which generation of ethanol as a key element?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which generation of biofuel is made from edible items such as sugar, corn and starch?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Apart from ethanol, which other biofuel is named as one of the most common biofuels?

Answer: _____

WED and UNEP: typed answers

Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam is a campaign that asks people to plant trees in memory of their mother, linking an emotional appeal with afforestation. The Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management and Planning Authority, known as CAMPA, has funds aimed at promoting afforestation and regeneration activities on waste, vacant and barren lands. Prakriti is the mascot used to spread greater awareness among masses about small changes that can be sustainably adopted in our lifestyle for a better environment. The year 2024 marked the 30th anniversary of the UN Convention to Combat Desertification. The 16th Session of its Conference of Parties was held in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia, in the same year. The UN Decade on Ecosystem Restoration is another international effort. India also launched Project Elephant as a conservation project. The Aravalli Green Wall Project was inspired by Africa's Great Green Wall and proposes a green belt of 1,400 km by 5 km from Porbandar in Gujarat to Panipat in Haryana. The National Mission for Green India aims to increase forest and tree cover on 5 million hectares of land and to improve the quality of forest cover on another 5 million hectares. It is one of the missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change.

Q1.

On which date is World Environment Day celebrated every year? (day and month)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was World Environment Day established? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which city is the headquarters of the UN Environment Programme located? (city)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which country was named Global Host for World Environment Day 2026? (country)

Answer: _____

Q5.

What was the theme of World Environment Day celebrated in 1973? (three words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which body organises World Environment Day? (give the abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which conference opened on the day that World Environment Day was established in 1972? (one word)

Answer: _____

Climate finance and the TFFF: typed answers

The International Solar Alliance was jointly launched by India and France at COP-21 in Paris in 2015. It covers solar resource-rich States that lie fully or partially between the Tropic of Cancer and the Tropic of Capricorn. The Alliance was officially established on 6 December 2017, on the entry into force of the Framework Agreement. Its work includes addressing obstacles that stand in the way of a rapid and massive scale-up of solar energy. It also aims to reduce the cost of finance and the cost of technology for the immediate deployment of competitive solar generation. India's first NDC submitted in 2015 set targets for emissions intensity, non-fossil power capacity and carbon sinks. The updated NDC submitted in 2022 raised the goals for 2030. The skill-up list includes the UNFCCC, the carbon market and Article 6 and 6.4 of the Paris Agreement. The National Mission for Green India, introduced in 2014, is one of the missions under the National Action Plan on Climate Change. Its goal includes adding forest and tree cover on 5 million hectares of land. Articles 48A and 51A(g) of the Indian Constitution are also listed among these points. The First Assembly of the Alliance was held at Delhi.

Q1.

At which COP was the NCQG on climate finance formally established? (give the city)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which city in Brazil hosted COP30, where the TFFF was launched? (give the city)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the NCQG per-year funding target for developing nations by 2035, in trillion dollars? (number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How many billion dollars a year have developed nations agreed to lead in mobilisation by 2035? (number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Along with Brazil, which country's presidency is named in the Baku-Belém Roadmap? (country)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What nickname is widely given to COP30 in Belém? (three words)

Answer: _____

Western Ghats and GRAPES-3 Facts

The Western Ghats run along India's west coast and are home to rich forests and many species. The government plans to notify Ecologically Sensitive Areas across this range, a step that has been pending for a long time. A draft notification comes before the final one, and such areas can include

biodiversity hotspots, wetlands, hills and rivers. Such areas are meant to regulate activities that could damage the environment, so that biodiversity, forests, wildlife habitats, water resources and ecological connectivity are protected. Restrictions apply to some heavy industrial and mining projects, while low-impact practices such as organic farming, rainwater harvesting and eco-tourism remain permitted. In space science, a cosmic-ray observatory in southern India has been used by scientists from more than one country to study the upper atmosphere in near real time. The basic objective of that observatory is to understand the origin, acceleration and propagation of cosmic rays. Such research helps scientists understand how particles from outer space behave. In the field of energy, a global assessment rates countries on how well they are shifting towards systems that are secure, sustainable, equitable and affordable. The assessment covers a large group of nations and offers a yearly snapshot of progress. Together, these topics show the range of environmental, scientific and energy issues in current affairs.

Q1.

Which Indian state hosts the GRAPES-3 cosmic-ray observatory?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Approximately how long, in km, does the Western Ghats extend along India's west coast?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the name of the highest peak in the Western Ghats, located in Kerala?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the Environment (Protection) Act enacted, under which ecologically fragile regions are notified?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Across how many states does the Western Ghats extend?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Researchers from which country joined India in using GRAPES-3 to track changes in Earth's upper atmosphere?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which organisation publishes the Energy Transition Index together with Accenture?

Answer: _____

FCRA, FATF and Peacekeeping Facts

The Ministry of Home Affairs has notified amended rules that tighten compliance for non-governmental organisations receiving money from abroad. Under the governing law, such organisations must register under approved categories, disclose their activities and public materials, and renew their registration before it expires. Registration certificates must specify the purposes and the states or union territories where activities will be carried out. Funds from overseas must first arrive in a designated account at a public sector bank, and they cannot be passed on to other bodies. Other parts of the rules deal with who may hold key roles in an organisation and how spending must be reported. Foreign contributions may be used for religious worship, religious education and community kitchens, but not for religious conversion. Separately, a body based in Europe works on combating money laundering and the financing of terrorism, and

it publishes lists of jurisdictions whose systems have weaknesses. The United Nations also runs peacekeeping missions, which involve military, police and civilian personnel. Each year a day is observed in honour of peacekeepers, and the theme for 2026 focuses on investing in peace. Recognition also goes to peacekeepers who work on gender issues in missions, reflecting principles adopted by the UN Security Council to protect women and girls in conflict zones.

Q1.

In which year was the FCRA Act that replaced the 1976 law enacted?

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many approved categories must an NGO register under at least one of?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which city is the designated FCRA account at the State Bank of India's main branch located?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which city is the headquarters of the Financial Action Task Force located?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which US-led initiative for secure supply chains of AI-critical technologies did India join in February 2026?

Answer: _____

Q6.

On which date is the International Day of UN Peacekeepers observed each year? (day and month)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which Indian officer received the UN Military Gender Advocate of the Year Award 2025 for work in UNIFIL, Lebanon?

Answer: _____

Heritage, Health and Yoga Facts

The Indus Valley Civilisation has left artefacts that continue to draw public attention. One bronze statuette, showing a young woman standing with one hand on her hip, was shown in a school textbook in a changed form before its original image was restored after criticism. It is estimated to be nearly 4,500 years old, and it was made using the lost-wax casting technique. The figurine shows a young female figure standing confidently, wearing a necklace and numerous bangles, and the civilisation it comes from was one of the most prominent urban centres of its era. The statuette is now housed in a national museum in the capital. Heritage also features in cultural cooperation: two countries are preparing a joint proposal to recognise an ancient travel account on a documentary heritage list. That account describes journeys across India and Central Asia during the seventh century CE. In health, a national survey collects data on fertility, nutrition and immunisation, and its latest round reports rising institutional deliveries and lower stunting among children. Yoga is promoted through an annual international observance that coincides with the summer solstice, and the United Nations General Assembly adopted a resolution to declare the day. Together, these topics show the variety of heritage, health and cultural issues in current affairs.

Q1.

In which year was the first International Day of Yoga observed?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Into how many categories were the Padma Awards reorganised in 1955?

Answer: _____

Q3.

From which Indus Valley city was the bronze Dancing Girl figurine excavated?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which archaeologist excavated the Dancing Girl figurine in 1926?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which ministry coordinates the International Day of Yoga activities?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the theme of International Day of Yoga 2026?

Answer: _____

Q7.

In which Indian city was the 2nd BRICS Culture Working Group Meeting held, where the Xuanzang nomination idea emerged?

Answer: _____